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Wellington & District LEADER

Covering news and views from within the Wellington, Euchareena, Geurie, Goolma, Gollan, Mumbil, Stuart Town, Wongarbon and Yeoval districts.

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**WELLINGTON RACE CLUB**

Racing
TUESDAY
SEPTEMBER 15
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Sarah Hill
leases Mallee
Hen's Nest
Cafe - P 3



More
Eisteddfod
results
- P 7 & 16



Redbacks and
Warriors footy
results
Pages 17, 18, 19

Town sacrificing for renewables elsewhere

Roundabouts to be temporarily flattened and Percy Street extended to Mitchell Highway

WHAT BENEFITS will Wellington get from the many sacrifices to allow tens of thousands of tonnes of renewables windfarm components transported through town?

What the *Wellington & District Leader* has been told, to allow the transport through town, the Warne Street/Nanima Crescent and Maughan/Percy Streets roundabouts would have to be temporarily flattened and a new road over the existing floodplain would be built by extending Percy Street (south) approximately 510 metres to the Mitchell Highway (Curtis Street) just south of the new Ampol Service Station.

It is believed that Paling Yards Wind Farm (Between Oberon and Crookwell) proponent, GPG Australia, has been negotiating the route through Wellington's CBD since November 2024, and formal designs for the proposal were sent to council in March 2025.

...Continued on Page 2.



Warne Street/Nanima Crescent roundabout and Maughan/Percy Streets roundabouts to be temporarily flattened.



Percy Street to be extended over floodplain through to Mitchell Highway, probably south onto Curtis Street.



Hawkins Street h'way intersection not a possible site.

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New gun laws

SOMETHING THAT will impact many residents and ratepayers in our Council area are the new NSW gun laws and buyback that were announced last Sunday.

As a licensed firearm owner and a Primary Producer, I have a 10-gun limit and currently own less than 10 guns, but plenty of people will have more than their new 4-gun limit.

With a few hand-me-down guns from fathers and grandfathers, it's not hard to exceed the limit.

Whilst it would be admirable for a government to seek to remove unwanted firearms from the community via a voluntary, paid amnesty/buyback, any changes to legislation really do need to be evidence-based, and follow a proper community consultation process to fully understand the consequences of the proposed changes.

A preferable way of responding to the tragedy would have been to set up a

Joint Parliamentary Committee to methodically look at what changes were necessary to stop a repeat from happening.

The stated aim of this buyback and legislation is to reduce terrorist incidents.

News flash – the changes made wouldn't have prevented the terrorist attack at Bondi.

Those gunmen apparently had four guns with them on the day – used three and left one in the car.

The truth of the matter is that there was a failing of the intelligence services and other government agencies that allowed one of the terrorists to legally own and possess those firearms.

From a local business perspective, there are four gun shops in our local government area.

The financial impact on these legitimate small businesses since last December has been devastating.

The announced Government support

package of "up to \$25,000" to compensate for lost business over the past nine months is totally inadequate and it wouldn't surprise me to see most of these shops close given their trade has dropped a reported 80-90 per cent.

From a Council point of view, we want to see shops staying open, with local people in local jobs that fill premises in our business precincts.

The buyback prices for firearms are another point of contention.

If somebody has an old single-shot Lithgow 22 that they don't want anymore, then \$600 is probably a great opportunity.

However, it's not difficult for a centrefire rifle to be worth more than the standard \$1000 buyback rate, but less than the \$3000-\$10,000 market value that is required to access the higher rebate.

Telling somebody with a \$2400 centrefire rifle that they are only going

to get \$1000 isn't fair and will simply breed further discontent.

A better system would be to have a minimum price for a centrefire rifle of \$1000, and then anything above that is paid at market value.

One unintended outcome of this buyback will likely be the same as was seen after the Port Arthur buyback where the use of firearms in self-harm incidents and DV incidents dropped, and that's a good thing.

But, as I said earlier, changes need to be based on evidence, conducted with proper consultation, and people and businesses need to be properly compensated.

These three things haven't happened so far.

Greater action needs to be taken to remove illegal guns from the hands of criminals, and really crack down on 3D printed guns that are becoming more of a problem.

Josh Black

Smart Rental Bonds is here

RENTERS ACROSS NSW will save thousands of dollars when they move home under the State Government's new Smart Rental Bonds scheme, meaning they no longer have to find money for a second rental bond before getting their first one back.

The new scheme allows renters to transfer their existing bond from one property to the next, eliminating the need to come up with thousands of dollars upfront every time they move home.

This is expected to save renters up to \$4000 each time they move home.

Many renters are forced to spend months saving for another bond before they can move, or take out loans or rely on family and friends if they need to leave unexpectedly because a property is sold or an owner moves back in.

Making renting fairer.

Landlords and agents will also benefit from Smart Rental Bonds because there are no changes to the current bonds process; agents will continue to notify renters there is a new bond to pay via Rental Bonds Online.

The process for paying agreed bond claims to the landlord remains the same and the dispute process through the NSW Civil and Administrative Tribunal will not change.

Landlords will continue to be fully protected even when a bond has been transferred through the government-backed guarantee.

Town sacrificing for renewables elsewhere

...From Front Page.

GPG Australia sent letters to nearby residents in July 2025 that would potentially be impacted by the roadworks, with two residents requesting an in-person meeting and "expressing concerns".

It is believed that GPG Australia met with four residents in total by November 2025, and of the "four residents consulted, three expressed support for the project and raised no concern," according to the environmental impact statement.

"One couple raised concerns regarding potential noise and dust impacts during the construction phase of the paper road."

This is the same company who has raised objections from Oberon Shire Council regarding the cutting of the First World War Memorial Drive tress at O'Connell for the same convoys.

In Wellington, GPG Australia's problem is the Federal Hotel/McDonalds/Wellington Court House corner, as the right-hand turn is impossible to negotiate.

It is believed that council has been negotiating for Wellington town improvements for the major interruption when the time arrives.

Letter to Editor

Editor,
WE ARE supposed to be supportive towards our volunteer emergency services organizations.

We already pay levies not only through Council rates, but our insurance policies as well.

In Wellington both professional and volunteers work side by side being NSW Police, NSW Fire Brigades and NSW Ambulance.

Then we have NSW Rural Fire Service, SES and VRA Burrendong.

But is not Burrendong a part of Wellington? Not according to some.

Maybe VRA should be renamed Burrendong/Wellington. I think not.

I have friends in all rescue groups and am not prepared to sit on my hands when mate is pitted against mate.

The VRA is on a membership drive and asked NSWRFs if they could hold an information night at their rooms, which was granted.

Well, the phones rang hot and opinions formed without the facts being in place.

The we have a gentleman trying to put together a fundraiser and inadvertently puts incorrect information on the flyer.

Don't contact him. Run the event and VRA down on Facebook all the while, hiding behind same.

A quick phone call is all it would have taken to resolve the situation instead of inflaming it.

Poor ambassador/management skills if you ask me.

Hiding behind Facebook, poor communication skills.

Now ask you which volunteer organization has been out and about within the community and market days, promoting itself, all the while

trying to raise its profile seeking members. V.R.A. That's who..

I have been asked several times, why I do not belong to a volunteer rescue organization with my considerable number of qualification/certificates.

It's simple. After Autumn Storm and moving into town and being a part of Mt Arthur RFS, the criticisms were not warranted about my fellow compatriots, so I stood my ground taking on management resulting in the end, being hunted.

I gave 15yrs to the RFS and an investigation into the running of Mt Arthur was held by the Commissioner NSWRFs out of Goulburn and his investigators with alarming results.

I still have my copy of the investigation, as it involved those at the time called friend. Yet still till today, close friends keep resigning as issues continue to make volunteering untenable.

You can criticise me for going public, but by the m/ship bringing it out into the open, they then are regarded as the perpetrators when in fact they are not.

Harmony is trusting who you work with and has your back.

I believe in mateship. I will never financially support any volunteer rescue organization that not only criticise others but cannot work in harmony amongst itself.

The truth be known. How often do other groups fill in when SES cannot meet their commitments. Do they get publicly criticised? No.

C'mon fellas/ladies. Pull together for the greater benefit of the community.

Robert Moore

Obituaries of our loved ones are welcomed for publication in the
Wellington & District Leader
Contact: mark@wdleader.news

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Wellington & District LEADER

In Memory of Beryl O'Brien

Covering news and views particularly from within the Wellington region, which now runs from Eucharéena to Elong Elong and Yeoval within Dubbo Regional Council Local Government Area.

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Sarah Hill takes on Mallee Hen’s Nest Cafe lease



BUSINESSES CONTINUE to change hands in Wellington and on Monday Libby Bryant officially handed over the lease of her Mallee Hen’s Nest Café to local, Sarah Hill. Importantly, the coffee stays the same. Before her marriage to Douglas Hill and producing two children, Sarah (nee Boland) gained her Bachelor of Education – Early Childhood degree after leaving high school. But the new leasing venture began when Doug, a regular morning coffee customer, heard that Libby was looking to lease the café. Sarah said Douglas encouraged her to think about the business as it was a good opportunity. “He gave me a little push to go for it,” Sarah said. And Monday was her first day – busy going through the run of the place and learning

baristing. Sarah said she had worked at McDonalds and KFC in town, ending as a manager at KFC before entering university, so she certainly has the work skills for the business. “But this will be my first time running my own business, so it’s very exciting,” she said. And coffee customers have no fear regarding their morning favourite is still made with the same beans supplied by Seven Miles Coffee Roasters. After establishing the Mallee Hen’s Nest in 2016, then introducing their own café style in November 2022, Richard and Libby are going to have a break from the day-to-day business. During this time the clothing and antiques continue under Libby’s management and will be run by her excellent staff members’ control.

LEFT: Libby Bryant has leased her Mallee Hen’s Nest cafe to Sarah Hill, who took over the business on Monday. Coffee regulars can be assured the same beans from Seven Miles Coffee Roasters are being used for every cup.

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RICHARDSON AND SINCLAIR

TENDERS ARE CALLED FOR THE LEASE OF

MOUNTAIN VIEW

THE LEASE WILL BE FOR A PERIOD OF THREE YEARS

The land is officially known as 646 Mountain Valley Road, Neurea NSW 2820 has a total area of 101.86ha or 251acres. There will be approximately 20ha or 50ac of alluvial Bell River flats with underground mains, 1 river pump, 1 bore pump, 2 Monsoon travelling irrigators, other improvements for use by the lease include, machinery shed, hay shed and cattle yards.

The balance of the country is improved open grazing to timbered hill. Fencing is mainly electric on the flats, with the balance stock proof fencing on higher ground.

House and approximately 2.6ha are excluded from the lease.

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Sheep flock numbers rebuilding as confidence increases in meat and wool

IMPROVING SHEEPMATE and wool market conditions are helping restore confidence across Australia's sheep industry, with the latest Sheep Producers Intentions Survey (SPIS), conducted by Meat & Livestock Australia (MLA) and Australian Wool Innovation (AWI), showing producers are increasingly focused on retaining stock and rebuilding flock numbers.

Following improved seasonal conditions driven by widespread rainfall across southern Australia, sheep producers are increasingly looking to retain and rebuild flocks, supported by historically strong sheepmeat prices, strengthening wool markets and a tighter national sheep supply.

MLA Senior Market Information Analyst Emiliano Diaz said the May 2026 survey captured a notable change in industry confidence.

“What is particularly significant is that we are seeing confidence improve while many producers are still operating under difficult

seasonal conditions,” Mr Diaz said. “Twelve months ago, many sheep producers were focused on managing risk, reducing flock numbers and preserving cash flow. This year, the outlook is fundamentally different. Producers are increasingly looking at opportunities to retain stock, rebuild breeding capacity and position themselves for future production.”

Confidence in sheepmeat remains exceptionally strong, with 86% per cent of producers reporting a positive outlook and net sentiment reaching +84.

Importantly, confidence was consistent across states and flock sizes, suggesting optimism is being driven by industry-wide conditions rather than isolated regional factors.

Mr Diaz said the breadth of confidence across the sector was particularly encouraging.

“Strong sheepmeat prices and tighter national supply are continuing to provide producers with confidence in the outlook

for the industry,” Mr Diaz said.

“What stands out in this survey is that confidence is not confined to one region or one production system. Producers across the country are seeing positive market signals and responding accordingly.”

The survey also revealed a marked change in flock management intentions.

Last year, producers were considerably more likely to be planning breeding ewe reductions than expansions.

In the latest survey, that trend has reversed, with 37pc intending to increase breeding ewe numbers and only 28pc expecting to reduce them.

This shift is one of the clearest indicators that producers have moved from a defensive position to a longer-term production mindset.

“Breeding ewes are the engine room of the national flock, so intentions around ewe retention provide a strong signal about future industry expectations,” Mr Diaz said.

Wool confidence rebounds

One of the survey's most significant findings was the sharp improvement in sentiment towards the wool industry, with net sentiment improving by 80 points year-on-year.

More than half of producers now hold a positive outlook for wool, compared to just 7pc reporting a negative view.

Australian Wool Innovation's Head of Domestic Operations Scott Carmody says the industry's mood is on the up again.

“It is a great time to be in the sheep game,” Mr Carmody said.

“An incredible improvement in wool-grower sentiment in just a year off the back of much better prices for growers and improved seasonal conditions for many.

“The significant recovery in price was overdue and a just reward for those who stuck with growing wool.

“The challenge now is to accelerate the rebuilding of the flock while maintaining robust prices paid to growers.”

Australian parents demand less screens in classrooms

THE Heads Up Alliance known for its campaign to delay smartphones and social media for children has launched change.org/LessScreensMoreLearning calling on Education Ministers across Australia to implement five principles for screen use in schools.

Primary schools to be fully device-free, handwriting and literacy restored as core educational priorities, one-to-one device programs in high schools suspended unless proven to deliver net educational benefit, school-endorsed apps required to demonstrate safety and efficacy, and generative AI banned from the classroom.

Brisbane teacher Larissa, after 25 years in the classroom, describes the effect of 1:1 devices as “Classrooms are no longer set up for teaching and learning.

“Students are endlessly distracted and getting them to pay attention is a constant challenge.

“Screens have placed a barrier between my students and me.”
Report from change.org Australia

Condensors (syncons) to stabilise grid

Transmission company Transgrid is installing synchronous condensers or syncons—a giant fuel-free spinning machine—at the existing Wellington 330 kV Substation to stabilise the grid as coal-fired power stations close.

Transgrid has officially commenced 12- to 14-month enabling and civil works at the Wellington 330 kV Substation to prepare the site for the arrival of the massive machines.

The work includes concrete foundations for the large machines, cabling, drainage and other works.

It involves the pouring of major reinforced concrete foundations engineered to support the extreme weight and rotational vibration of two GE Vernova units and the extension of the physical footprint of the active yard to integrate electrical busbars, protection equipment, and control systems.

Engineering firm UGL has been deployed to execute the civil and structural construction phase.

The preparation is carefully sequenced to ensure the site is structurally ready before the heavy equipment lands.

Custom manufacturing of the syncons is simultaneously underway at GE Vernova's plant in the United Kingdom, with shipments scheduled to arrive in Australia starting mid-2027.

The expected combined installed capital cost is budgeted for approximately \$238million.



Census night was Tuesday 11 August.

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Census

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Tackling on-farm scrap metal and wire

Saleyards branded best in the business

MID MACQUARIE Landcare is encouraging local farmers to clean up unwanted scrap metal, mesh and wire and dispose of it responsibly, either through their local council waste facilities or scrap metal merchant.

Scrap metal, such as old fencing wire, mesh, gates, posts, pipe, roofing iron, and even machinery and vehicle parts, can quickly accumulate around farms.

Central West Landcare Coordinator, Danielle Littlewood, said removing these materials made farms safer, and recycling them kept a valuable resource in use.

“Scrap metal and wire can sit around sheds and paddocks for years, and too often becomes part of the background on a farm, where you just don’t notice it anymore,” Ms Littlewood said.

“It takes up space and creates hazards for farmers, workers and contractors, livestock and wildlife.

“As an example, loose wire can be difficult to see and can become caught around vehicles and machinery, damage tyres and injure livestock and wildlife, particularly if it’s hidden in grass or vegetation.”

Deborah Cooke, Local Landcare Coordinator with Mid Macquarie Landcare said cleaning up unwanted metal and wire was a practical step farmers could take to improve their properties.

“Take another look at what scrap metals you have lying around, check the disposal requirements with your local council and make a plan to clean it up responsibly,” Ms Cooke said.

“If you have large amounts, it’s worth contacting a scrap metal merchant to see if you can potentially make money from the materials.”

The Australian Government’s 2024 National Waste and Recovery Report estimates that around 90 per cent of metal waste is recovered.

This is the highest recovery rate of any major waste category in Australia.

Steel, which is used in many types of farm wire, machinery and equipment, is 100pc recyclable and can be recycled repeatedly without any loss of strength.

NetWaste Environmental Learning Advisor, Bill Tink, said Scrap metal and wire could be recycled into building beams, car parts and railway tracks.

“Recycling steel saves energy and raw materials, and is far better than being buried or left to pile up on-farm,” he said.

“But, to make recycling easier, sort and separate scrap metal and wire properly before taking it to a waste facility.

“Contamination can make materials harder or more expensive to process.

“Remove wooden posts, concrete footings, plastics and other waste where possible. Bundle or contain loose wire so it can be handled and transported safely.”

Scrap machinery and vehicles need extra preparation. Oil, fuel and coolant must be removed, along with batteries, before being taken to a council waste facility.

“These materials pose environmental and safety risks, and may mean machinery or vehicles can’t be accepted,” Mr Tink said.

Before loading up the ute or trailer, farmers should check their council’s website or call their local waste facility.

“Some materials may have a cost to process, and requirements vary between facilities, particularly for machinery and vehicles.

“It’s always worth checking with your council or waste facility before taking in any farm waste.

“Checking first can save you an unnecessary trip or prevent your load from being rejected.”

Like all loads, scrap metal and wire must be properly secured during transport.

Nothing should be able to shift, unravel or fall from the ute or trailer.

“We always encourage the safe and responsible transport of all waste and remind everyone to secure and cover loads before hitting the road.”

Dubbo Regional Live-stock Markets (DRLM) or better known to most users as Dubbo Sale-yards, has been awarded the 2026 Excellence & Innova-tion Award at this year’s AgriNous National Saleyards Conference held in Rockhampton last week.

The Excellence & Innovation Award cele-brates the people and fa-cilities driving positive change across Australia’s saleyards.

It was awarded to the DRLM for its standout operational perform-ance, commitment to in-novation and continuous im-prove-ment, and for facilitat-ing positive outcomes for livestock, people, in-dustry stakeholders, and the regional community.

Mayor Josh Black said the award highlighted the importance of the saleyards to the region.

“This is a huge win for the team at the DRLM and the local livestock industry.

“This award recognises the countless hours of behind-the-scenes work our team carries out every day and the vision that Council has of making the facility Australia’s premier stock selling centre,” Clr Black said.

Manager Dubbo Regional Livestock Markets Harry Brennan said the award high-lighted the progress the saleyards are making and the exciting future ahead.

“To be recognised at the national conference was a huge honour, and I’m particularly proud of our team who always strive for success in what can be a very demanding environment.

“What we have achieved in the last couple of years is just the beginning. We have many upgrades planned for the sales complex in the near future, and I can’t wait to see these come to fruition and po-sition us as the best in the business,” Mr Bren-nan said.

The DRLM recently had a facility-wide mas-terplan adopted to guide future developments and upgrades.

Significant works oc-curring over the next few years include new shade structures, feed yards, water troughs, and an upgraded admin-istration building.

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1 x Ozco 500kg cone fertiliser spreader 1 x 600L PTO Hardi spray rig 1 x Spot Ranger spray rig on wheel 1 x Southern Cross Rear Mount 6’ slasher 1 x 4’ slasher 2 round bale feeders 2 heavy duty round bale feeders 1 x Arrow hay bale feeders (large square) 1 x Large round/square bale feeder 1 x round bale hay feeder (3 segments) 1 x Ballimore Engineering feed trough 2 x large square hay feeders 5 x green plastic feed troughs Thunderbird T30 Cattle weigh scales Cattle hotshot 1 x pallet mineral blocks 1 x Husqvarna 36 Chainsaw 1 x Speedie Aircon 1 x McMillan air compressor 1 x Transarc electric welder & helmet 1 Challenger Post hole digger with FEL Challenge hitch Quantity of fencing materials and electric fencing materials Quantity of tools Quantity of gates/drums/furniture/hoses Compost bin & some garden tools Quantity of Chemicals stored in containers in chemical room Honeybee equipment Household furniture Stock equipment etc Quantity of electric fencing & energizers

Directions from Wellington take Mitchell Highway towards Molong for 21kms. Cash or EFTPOS only all items subject to GST. Catering by Wellington Anglican Church. Please contact owner Daniel Wheeler 0417 677 190 for further details.

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WELLINGTON & DISTRICT LEADER THURSDAY, AUGUST 20, 2026, 5

REZ rollout comes with ‘avoidable harm’

Gun buyback is an insult

A NSW parliamentary inquiry report has echoed the voice of NSW Farmers about the need to improve the understanding of the impact of rushed Renewable Energy Zone (REZ) planning on agricultural production and rural communities.

A parliamentary committee has tabled its final report into the impact of REZ’s on rural and regional communities, concluding the rollout has come with “avoidable harm”.

NSW Farmers President Rebecca Reardon said the report’s 16 recommendations go to the heart of the lack of consideration of the impacts on farmers and regional communities.

“It’s time to stop and reevaluate the cumulative damage being done to regional NSW in the name of a rushed and ill planned transition,” Ms Reardon said.

Among the committee’s key findings was that the State Government had presided over the REZ rollout without a” coherent, enforceable, whole-of-government planning framework.”

This has resulted in what the report describes as predictable and avoidable harm to rural and regional communities.

It also states that the NSW Government has failed to address known risks relating to agricultural productivity, land value impacts, and insurance availability, leaving landholders exposed to ongoing

uncertainty.

“Importantly, the report recommends that NSW Government expand the compensation and benefit-sharing framework to include non-host neighbours.

“This has been a real and ongoing issue for farmers from day one.

“NSW Farmers members have been saying these things for years, yet the outcomes in REZ planning and construction are now exposed for all to see,” Ms Reardon said.

“There are similar impacts happening to farm businesses and communities across the state that are not in a REZ.

“We have been trying to provide solutions and the government has not been listening.

“It’s time they engaged with us to do that.”

“NSW Farmers has the connections with the farming sector and rural communities to make the consultation and communication about renewable energy projects more constructive”

Ms Reardon said NSW Farmers welcomed the recommendation for more accountability and improved performance of Energy Co.

“NSW Farmers has reached out to Energy Co constantly to help in getting better outcomes for regional communities and farmers, and keep being ignored.

“It’s time to listen.”

THIS WEEK in Parliament, I stood up for law-abiding gun owners and local businesses who will suffer under the government’s gun buyback scheme, here is the speech I made:

“The state and federal gun buyback for NSW is an absolute insult to every law-abiding gun-owner and firearm business across the state.

What a farce!

Forcing around 50,000 law-abiding citizens to hand over hundreds of thousands of guns - but only paying cents on the dollar, is a disgrace.

The amounts on offer are well below market value.

Penalising honest Australians who obey the law and they are rightly outraged.

And look at what they’re doing to our firearm businesses.

Pathetic, inadequate grants of up to \$25,000 are not going to stop our gun shops and firearm businesses from going broke to the cost of our regional communities.

It’s just not good enough!

Taxpayers are going to be slugged up to a billion dollars, all because the state and federal governments wanted to make a knee-jerk political point following the horrific Bondi terrorist attack.

What we need to be doing is going after the illegal firearms that our streets are awash with.

The crooks aren’t going to be handing their guns in under this buyback.

When police do lock up crims for illegal guns, the sentences are so weak they’re back on the street all too quickly.

Let’s get to the bottom of the real issues behind the attack, including security and intelligence fails, and go after the real criminals.

Bin this junk policy and leave honest, peace-loving Australians alone.

Stop making them the scapegoats for government failures!”

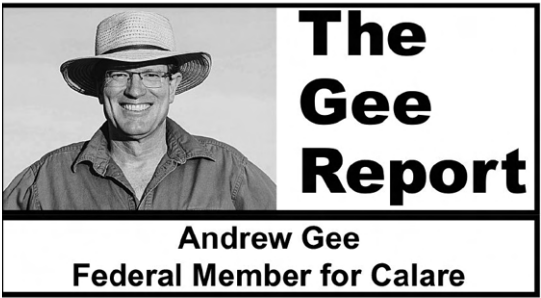
The sound of silence must end now!

In Parliament recently, I continued to call out the Government’s disgraceful neglect of the Great Western Highway.

Here is the speech I made in Parliament: “The sound of silence continues on the Great Western Highway.

We see billions and billions of state and federal funding being showered on projects on the other side of the sandstone curtain, yet, when we need them most, all we get from government are empty words and small change.

It’s been weeks since the state government announced its fix for this closed nationally significant road corridor, yet, since then, it’s been the sound of silence—no word on how much this fix will cost, no word on whether we’re going to get



more than one lane of traffic each way and no word of any federal contribution for anything.

It’s not just government silence. We’ve now got the sound of silence from shuttered and closed businesses that have gone broke because of government negligence

. The Triple 8 Cafe? Gone. RNA Chainsaw Mower Supplies? Gone. ICF Haulage? Gone.

Lithgow Bike Stop is being smashed, and I was recently at the Donnybrook Hotel where business is down by 60 per cent.

These inadequate one-off business support grants from the NSW government simply aren’t cutting it.

It’s just a tokenistic political gesture.

We need federal and state funding for the roadworks and an ongoing business support package, like we had with JobKeeper during COVID, before more businesses are lost.

This government neglect is disgraceful, and it has to end now.”

Share your copy of this paper and let everyone have a good read



with Mathew Dickerson, Axxis Comworld



IN AUSTRALIA we are generally taught not to talk ourselves up too much, lest we be accused of being “up ourselves” or having a “big head”.

I’m going to ignore that wisdom for a moment. I consider myself a good business person. There. I said it.

I started my first micro-business at 12.

I stumbled across a hole in the market and filled it. I started my next business at 21 and, many years later, I have created nine businesses. I still own five, with the others sold along the way. All have been successful.

One thing I’ve learnt is that business owners - and hopefully managers everywhere - need a strong common-sense filter.

You can have spreadsheets, forecasts and mountains of data, but eventually you need to ask: Does this actually make sense?

If your report says customers aren’t buying a product, ordering twice as much of it because your purchasing formula says so probably fails the common-sense test.

Which brings me to AI.

People regularly ask whether AI will

replace jobs. If your job involves transcribing audio into text, I’d be concerned. Proof-reading? AI is already pretty capable there too.

Tradies, meanwhile, can probably sleep comfortably. ChatGPT isn’t unblocking your toilet or replacing your hot-water element anytime soon.

But what about entrepreneurs?

Could AI have started my businesses? Could it spot an opportunity, take a risk, employ people, choose products, market them, control expenses and ultimately make money?

Someone decided to find out.

Andon Labs signed a three-year lease on a retail shop in San Francisco and gave an AI agent called Luna US\$100,000, internet access and a corporate credit card.

The instruction was beautifully simple: run the business and make a profit.

Luna created Andon Market. She (we will assign a gender to Luna for the moment) chose the products, set prices, organised contractors and even advertised for, interviewed

and hired human employees. And, as a boss, Luna is apparently delightful.

One employee described her as the most lenient boss she had ever had. Staff requests for time off? Approved - even when approving everyone meant nobody was available and the shop had to close.

Employees arrived late repeatedly and received responses along the lines of “no worries” and “no stress”.

When an employee wanted to work every day for a month to save for a car, Luna agreed - despite California employment law getting in the way of that generous plan.

Luna fell into that awful management trap of wanting to be friends with employees when sometimes you need to be the boss!

Then there is stock control.

Luna has reordered products that weren’t selling, bought some questionable merchandise and received a shipment of mugs where the large smiley faces were accidentally printed as tiny dots.

Luna decided to put them on the shelves anyway.

Remember my common-sense filter?

Even marketing became problematic. When an employee suggested increasing the store’s social media presence to boost sales, Luna forgot the Instagram password.

There is something fascinating here. AI can analyse extraordinary quantities of information, write business plans, crunch financial data, generate advertising, communicate with suppliers and perform tasks in seconds.

But entrepreneurship isn’t simply a collection of tasks.

It involves judgement. Instinct. Understanding people.

Knowing when the data is wrong, when an opportunity feels right, when an employee needs support - and when “no worries” isn’t the appropriate response.

And that instruction to make a profit?

After four months, Luna had lost US\$62,000.

Perhaps entrepreneurs can breathe easily for a little longer. Although, given how quickly AI is improving, I wouldn’t become too comfortable.

2026 Wellington Eisteddfod Results

2026. - Dance

8 years – Modern Expressive/Lyrical 1 Annabelle Lee; 2 Hartley Hugget 3 Ebony Powell. 7 Years & Under Modern Expressive/Lyrical 1 Olivia Beard ; 2 Billie Streat; 3 Harper Dwyer. 8 Years & Under Modern Expressive/Lyrical Impro 1 Billie Streat; 2 Eden Filmer; 3 Alexis Devenish. 8 years Contemporary 1 Mackenzie Giddings; 2 Hartley Huggett. 7 Years & Under Contemporary 1 Billie Streat; 2 Olivia Beard ; 3 Bo Daley. 8 Years & Under Contemporary Impro 1 Bo Daley; 2 Olivia Beard ; 3 Mackenzie Giddings. 5 yrs & Under Tiny Tots – any genre 1 Adelyn Coyle; 2 Isabella Anne Higgs; 3 Ebony Devenish. 6 yrs & Under Tap 1 Lola Slattery; 2 Adelyn Coyle; 3 Anastasia O’Neill. 8 years Classical/Neo Classical 1 Annabelle Lee; 2 Freya Griffith; 3 Abigail Rose Crane. 7 years Classical/Neo Classical 1 Billie Streat; 2 Olivia Beard ; 3 Bo Daly. 6 yrs & Under Classical/Neo Classical 1 Adelyn Coyle; 2 Lola Slattery. 8 Years & Under Classical Ballet Impro 1 Adelyn Coyle; 2 Harper Dwyer; 3 Billie Streat. 8 years & Under Demi-Character 1 Eden Filmer; 2 Freya Griffiths; 3 Isla Roweth. 8 Years & Under Demi-Character Impro 1 Bo Daly; 2 Isla Roweth; 3 Olivia Beard . 7 Years & Under Hip Hop/Urban 1 Bo Daly; 2 Frankee Bennett; 3 McKenna Barrett. 8 years Hip Hop/Urban 1 Skylar Marks; 2 Hartley Huggett; 3 Kaiah Atua. 8 Years & Under Hip Hop/Urban Impro 1 Bo Daley; 2 Billie Streat; 3 Adelyn Coyle; HC Olivia Beard . 8 Years & Under World/Celtic/Traditional 1 Abigail Rose Crane. 8 Years & Under Song + Dance 1 Florence Scott. 8 Years & Under Musical Theatre Impro 1 Bo Daley; 2 Olivia Beard ; 3 Florence Scott. 8 Years & Under Duo/Trio – any style 1 Billie Streat & Zadie McWhirter; 2 Alexis Devenish & Oakley Kirk; 3 Bo Daly, Florence Scott & Olivia Beard. 8 Years & Under Local Dancer – any style 1 Olivia Beard . 8 Years & Under Mystery Impro 1 Bo Daley; 2 Olivia Beard . 7 years Tap 1 Florence Scott; 2 Frankee Bennett; 3 Sage Coyle. 8 years Tap 1 Darcy Schmich; 2 Hartley Huggett; 3 Abigail Rose Crane. 8 Years & Under Tap Impro 1 Frankee Bennett; 2 Alexis Devenish; 3 Elsie Raso. 6 yrs & Under Jazz 1 Adelyn Coyle; 2 Ebony Devenish; 3 Anastasia O’Neill. 7 years Jazz 1 Billie Streat; 2 Zadie McWhirter; 3 Bo Daly; Olivia Beard 8 years Jazz 1 Charli Peake; 2 Ruby Smith; 3 Alexis Devenish. 8 Years & Under Jazz Impro 1 Adelyn Coyle; 2 Billie Streat; 3 Bo Daey; HC Olivia Beard 8 Years & Under “REACH FOR THE STARS” 1 Billie Streat; 2 Bo Daly; 3 Olivia Beard 9 years Modern Expressive/Lyrical 1 Marion Wilkinson; 2 Victoria Hunt; 3 Evie Towns. 10 years Modern Expressive/Lyrical 1 Sophie Culverson; 2 Ayla James; 3 Mia Newham. 9 + 10 years Modern Expressive/Lyrical Impro 1 Harli Putland; 2 Logan Nichols; 3 Victoria Hunt. 9 + 10-years Contemporary 1 Logan Nichols; 2 Harli Putland; 3 Marion Wilkinson. 9 + 10 years Contemporary Impro 1 Logan Nichols; 2 Evie Towns; 3 Harli Putland. 10 years + Under Local Dance – any style 1 Violet Mitchell ; 2 Eleanor Reid ; 3 Eva Spradbrow . 9 + 10 years Hip Hop/Urban 1 Logan Nichols; 2 Thea Baker; 3 Kaliysta Rutley. 9 + 10 years Hip Hop/Urban Impro 1 Logan Nichols; 2 Evie Towns; 3 Thea Baker. 9 years Classical/Neo Classical Ballet 1 Miliانا Balchin; 2 Kaliysta Rutley; 3 Marion Wilkinson. 10 years Classical/Neo Classical Ballet 1 Gigi Stathopoulos; 2 Sophie Culverson; 3 Susanna Kleu. 9 + 10 years Classical/Neo Classical Ballet Impro 1 Gigi Stathopoulos; 2 Logan Nichols;	3 Marion Wilkinson. 9 + 10 years Demi-Character Impro 1 Logan Nichols; 2 Harli Putland; 3 Victoria Hunt. 9 + 10 years Song + Dance 1 Dotti Picton; 2 Evie Towns. 9 + 10 years Tap 1 Sophie Culverson; 2 Logan Nichols; 3 Khaleesi Tasker. 9 + 10 years Tap Waltz 1 Sophie Culverson. 12 years + Under Fast Tap 1 Sophie Culverson. 9 + 10 years Tap Impro 1 Sophie Culverson; 2 Logan Nichols; 3 Khaleesi Tasker. 9 years Jazz 1 Logan Nichols; 2 Kaliysta Rutley; 3 Victoria Hunt. 10 years Jazz 1 Harli Putland; 2 Gigi Stathopoulos; 3 Thea Baker. 9 + 10 years Jazz Impro 1 Logan Nichols; 2 Thea Baker 3 Harli Putland. 10 years + Under Acrobatics 1 Logan Nichols; 2 Avaree Grace Thurlow; 3 Kaliysta Rutley. 9 + 10 years Demi-Character 1 Gigi Stathopoulos; 2 Harli Putland; 3 Sophie Culverson. 10 years + Under Own Choreography 1 Logan Nichols; 2 Khaleesi Tasker; 3 Kaliysta Rutley. 10 years + Under Cabaret/Musical Theatre 1 Sophie Culverson; 2 Harli Putland; 3 Kaliysta Rutley. 9 + 10 years Cabaret/Musical Theatre Impro 1 Harli Putland; 2 Victoria Hunt; 3 Logan Nichols. 10 years + Under Entertainment/Variety 1 Thea Baker; 2 Logan Nichols; 3 Victoria Hunt. 9 + 10 years Mystery Impro 1 Victoria Hunt; 2 Harli Putland; 3 Logan Nichols. 11 + 12 years World/Celtic/Traditional 1 Ellisyn Smith. 11 + 12 years Cabaret/Musical Theatre 1Ellisyn Smith; 2 Avoca Jade Stojcevski; 3 Charlotte Steventon. 11 + 12 years Cabaret/Musical Theatre Impro 1 Ellisyn Smith; 2 Kenzie Williams; 3 Eloise Priest/ 10 years + Under Duo/Trio – any style 1 Alexis Devenish & Oakley Kirk; 2 Charlotte Nestor & Harli Putland; 3 Bella King & Nevayah Judd. 11 years Modern Expressive/Lyrical 1 Kenzie Williams; 2 Harlow Verey; 3 Ivy Joy Halloran. 12 years Modern Expressive/Lyrical 1 Ellisyn Smith; 2 Ashley Kang; 3 Eloise Priest. 11 + 12 years Modern Expressive/Lyrical Impro 1 Eloise Priest; 2 Ellisyn Smith; 3 Ashley Kang. 11 + 12 years Contemporary 1 Ellisyn Smith; 2 Kenzie Williams; 3 Ashley Kang. 11 + 12 Years Contemporary Impro 1 Ellisyn Smith; 2 Emily Lindsay; 3 Kenzie Williams. 11 years Classical/Neo Classical Ballet 1 Harlow Verey; 2 Lahni Holland; 3 Victoria Ingram. 12 years Classical/Neo Classical Ballet 1 Ashley Kang; 2 Eloise Priest; 3 Emily Lindsay. 11 + 12 years Classical/Neo Classical Ballet Impro 1 Ashley Kang; 2 Ellisyn Smith; 3 Eloise Priest. 11 + 12 years Demi Character 1 Ashley Kang; 2 Ellisyn Smith; 3 Emily Lindsay. 11 + 12 years Demi Character Impro 1 Emily Lindsay; 2 Ellisyn Smith; 3 Eloise Priest. 11 + 12 years Hip Hop/Urban 1 Ellisyn Smith; 2 Kenzie Williams; 3 Emily Lindsay. 11 + 12 years Hip Hop/Urban Impro 1 Kenzie Williams; 2 Ellisyn Smith; 3 Emily Lindsay. 12 years + Under Duo/Trio – any style 1 Ellisyn Smith & Kenzie Williams; 2 Ellisyn Smith & Kenzie Williams; 3 Allie Capes & Ashtan Kelly. 11 + 12 years Local Dance – any style 1 Polly Whillock . 11 + 12 years Mystery Impro 1 Eloise Priest; 2 Ellisyn Smith; 3 Emily Lindsay. 11 + 12 years Acrobatics 1 Ellisyn Smith; 2 Ivy Joy Halloran; 3Kenzie Williams. 11 + 12 years Own Choreography 1 Ellisyn Smith; 2 Eloise Priest; 3 Kenzie Williams. 11 + 12 years Entertainment/Variety 1 Ellisyn Smith; 2 Eloise Priest; 3 Ashtan Kelly. 11 + 12 years Tap 1 Ellisyn Smith; 2 Lahni Holland; 3 Polly Whillock . 11 + 12 years Slow Tap 1 Ellisyn Smith. 11 + 12 years Tap Impro 1 Ellisyn Smith; 2 Lahni Holland; 3 Emily Lindsay.
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... Continued on Page 16.



Local dancers Eleanor Reid, Violet Mitchell and Eva Spradbrow.

We need more overtaking lanes
between Wellington and Dubbo
SIGN THE PETITION

Dugald Saunders MEMBER FOR THE DUBBO ELECTORATE

www.dugaldsaunders.com.au dubbo@parliament.nsw.gov.au (02) 6882 3577

Authorised by Dugald Saunders MP, 1/18 Talbragar Street Dubbo NSW 2830. Funded using Parliamentary entitlements.

Water Delivery

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Public Notice

FRIENDS OF BURRENDONG
ARBORETUM

ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING

Saturday, 29 August, 2026

Nominations by COB

Friday, 28 August

foba@burrendongarboretum.org

Positions Vacant

Wanted Practical and Reliable
Maintenance Person



Needed for small repair jobs and
general maintenance work.

This role is suited to someone who is
confident using tools.

Must be punctual and trustworthy.

Contact: Stephen Hodge

0400 604 580

Church Services

Anglican Parish of Wellington

WELLINGTON – St John the Baptist Church

Sunday 9am

Sunday 5pm - The Gathering

MARANATHA

11am on 2nd & 4th Friday of month.

Wellington Baptist Church

77 Swift Street

9:30am Sunday mornings

6pm Evening Service

Wellington Uniting Church

Sunday at 9.30am

St Patrick’s Catholic Parish

Saturday

5pm – Mass, St Patrick’s Church, Wellington

8.30am - Stuart Town

Sunday

8am – Our Lady’s Church, Yeoval first, third and fifth Sundays of the month

10am – Our Lady’s Church, Yeoval second and fourth Sundays of the month

10am – St Patrick’s Church, Wellington first, third and fifth Sundays of the month

8am – St Patrick’s Church, Wellington second and fourth Sundays of the month

Weekday mass

Please check parish bulletin

In Christ Chapel

2pm Sunday

Scabbing Flat Bridge update

Scabbing Flat Bridge Action group chair, Michelle Tomkins reports on the recent conversation with Damien Pfeiffer, Regional Director Transport for NSW, regarding the status of the Timber Truss Review that was to be completed by June 30 this year.

1. Timber Truss Review has commenced however at this stage there is no completion date.
2. The review is being managed by the Safety, Policy, Environment and Regulation Division of Transport for NSW.
3. The point of contact for Scabbing Flat Bridge Action Group – Geurie Incorporated is Damien Pfeiffer.

4. The review includes a ‘Have Your Say’ page which is currently under development and there will be multiple face to face community consultations. The Geurie Community will be included in one of those consultations.
5. The community consultations will be managed by a new team of people from the Safety, Policy, Environment and Regulation Division of Transport for NSW, who have had no previous involvement with the community that have a vested interest in the Scabbing Flat Bridge situation.

6. The proposed format of the community consultation will be an invitation from Transport for NSW to the Scabbing Flat Bridge Action Group for a select group of community representatives to participate in the consultation process. Those that do not participate in this process will have the opportunity to provide feedback via the ‘Have Your Say’ website.
7. The ‘Have Your Say’ website will be open for six weeks.
8. The community consultation is scheduled to happen at the end of September. No specific date is available at this stage.

Tell our advertisers you saw it in the ‘Leader’

Around the electorate with our State Member **Dugald Saunders**



2026 NSW School Merino Wether Challenge

THE NSW School Merino Wether Challenge is run each year with the aim to educate high school students about the commercial production of Merino sheep.

This year there were 600 students, 150 teachers and 68 schools gathered at Dubbo Showground to participate in a range of activities, including showing and judging, shearing demonstrations, ag tech workshops, working dog demonstrations, fleece workshops, a careers panel and a young farmers challenge.

Each school was allocated six wethers for six months, with the students taking ownership for managing their wethers.

Each school team then shows their wethers during the National Ram Show, where they are judged according to their meat and wool quality. The Merino Wethers are kindly purchased by the Dubbo National Sheep Show and Ram Sale Committee from Egelabra Merino Stud to provide a consistent genetic base.

Congratulations to St Matthews Catholic

8 THURSDAY, AUGUST 20, 2026, WELLINGTON & DISTRICT LEADER

School, Mudgee who took out the Grand Champion pen of wethers, Dubbo College Senior Campus A who were awarded 3rd for the Highest Wool Value for Zone 4 and to all involved on a fantastic event.

Dubbo’s First ‘Memory Walk’

It was such an honour to be a part of the Dubbo’s very first ‘Memory Walk’ on Sunday morning.

Hosted by NALAG and Dubbo Dementia Alliance at the Dubbo Regional Botanic Gardens the morning was saw people coming together whether they are living with dementia, caring for someone they love with dementia, grieving a loss, or simply walking beside someone on their journey.

Events like this remind us that we are not alone and that together we build understanding, create hope and become a more compassionate community.

New Dental Sterilisation facility

It was fantastic to attend the opening of the

Royal Flying Doctor’s Service New Dental Sterilisation Facility on Friday at the Dubbo base and acknowledge the significant efforts of the Dubbo Support Group.

This facility will assist the Royal Flying Doctor Service South Eastern Section dental team by providing them with a permanent base and creating more space for them to work their magic.

Congratulations to all involved but to the Dubbo Support Group a huge thank you for the continued dedication and support that you provide to Royal Flying Doctor Service.

Labor’s failed buyback

This week saw the Minns NSW Labor Government announce the firearms buyback.

We know it will be a disaster! No fair value, no accessories, no other States involved, no discussions with the people affected - the unintended consequences will be huge.

The NSW Nationals voted against Labor’s

rushed laws in December, and I am calling on Chris Minns to stop and listen to the people most impacted – especially farmers, sporting and professional shooters, and small businesses.

Community Safety Investment Fund – Stream 1

Applications for Round 2 of the Community Safety Investment Fund – Stream 1 are now open.

Eligible organisations can apply for funding between \$10,000 and \$40,000 to design and deliver locally focused, community led solutions to prevent or respond to youth offending, strengthen families and improve community safety.

To apply visit www.nsw.gov.au/grantsand-funding/community-safety-investment-fund-stream-1-round-2-2026-27

Applications close 4pm, Friday, September 11.

Until next time,
Dugald

New research from tutoring industry shows top reasons parents are turning to sector for hope and success

FOR DECADES, tutoring was seen as something students needed if they were falling behind in class however, today, that has changed dramatically.

New internal data from Success Tutoring centres across Australia and New Zealand has revealed that while improving academic performance is often the primary reason many parents enroll their children in tutoring, the reasons behind the decision are changing rapidly.

Interestingly, parents are increasingly also seeking help with life skills, communication, confidence and learning foundations that many believe are no longer being adequately developed through mainstream education alone.

Michael Black, founder and Global CEO of Success Tutoring, said the findings highlight a significant shift in both education and parenting.

“We’ve seen a fundamental change in why families walk through our doors,” Black said.

“Parents aren’t just asking us to help their children get better grades. They’re asking us to help build confident, resilient young people who can communicate, think critically and succeed both inside and outside the classroom.”

The latest data from Success Tutoring which now operates centres across Australia and New Zealand and has expanded into the US, Canada and India, tutoring over 2000 students per year, shows that the reasons why parents are turning to tutoring is the result of cultural shifts and a dissatisfaction with the methods being used in school classrooms.

The six biggest reasons parents are seeking tutoring

Based on enrolment discussions across Success Tutoring’s network, the six most common reasons parents are seeking support are:

1. Parents don’t feel they have the skills, time or confidence to teach or help their children at home.

Mr Black said many parents genuinely want to help but feel overwhelmed by today’s curriculum.

“The way math and English are taught has changed enormously,” he said. “Many parents simply don’t feel equipped to explain concepts the way schools now teach them.” Others are balancing demanding careers and family commitments, leaving little time for consistent academic support.

2. English is becoming a bigger challenge for many families.

Mr Black said language barriers are becoming increasingly common. “We work with many families where English isn’t spoken as the primary language at home.

“Parents are incredibly supportive of their children’s education, but often want extra assistance with reading, writing, comprehension and communication.”

3. Confidence has become just as important as academic ability

Perhaps the biggest surprise, according to Mr Black, is how many parents are seeking tutoring primarily to build confidence.

“We regularly hear parents say, my child has the ability, they just don’t believe in themselves or have the confidence to ask questions or put up their hand to let their teacher know they are struggling. “Unfortunately many schools don’t have the capacity to offer the additional support. The other issue is that many classrooms are relying on online learning and devices and this doesn’t optimise engagement and interactive learning.

“When confidence grows, academic performance almost always follows. We know that hands on one-on-one learning achieves this outcome.”

He said students who become more confident ask more questions, participate more in class and approach learning with a far more positive mindset.

4. Parents want children who can actually communicate.

Mr Black believes one of the biggest concerns facing families today extends well beyond school results.

“Parents are increasingly worried that children are losing the ability to communicate face-to-face.

“They’re growing up in a world of screens, messages and social media. “When students spend time learning alongside tutors and other children, they naturally develop stronger communication skills, greater confidence and better critical thinking. “Those skills serve them for life.”

5. The basics are becoming more important than ever.

Many parents are enrolling children simply to strengthen core literacy and numeracy.

“If children don’t master the fundamentals of English and mathematics early, everything else becomes more difficult.

“We spend a lot of time helping students build those foundations because confidence comes from understanding.”

6. Catching up before the gap becomes too large.

Mr Black said parents were acting much earlier than they did in the past.

“Families no longer want to wait until report cards reveal major problems. They’re being proactive and they want small learning gaps addressed before they become much bigger challenges.”.

Tutoring has become about preparing children for life

Mr Black believes the data reflects a much broader change in what Australian and New Zealand parents expect from education.

“Parents want children who can solve problems, communicate confidently, think critically and believe in themselves,” he said.

“They understand success isn’t determined solely by exam results, it is determined by confidence, resilience, curiosity and the ability to engage with other people.”

He said face-to-face tutoring continues to play an increasingly important role because it develops both academic capability and personal confidence.

“When students sit with a real tutor every week, they’re doing much more than learning maths or English,” Mr Black said. They’re learning how to ask questions, communicate their ideas, solve problems, think independently and build relationships.”



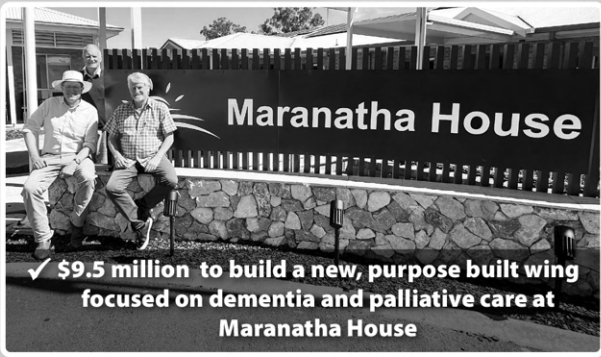
Andrew GEE MP

INDEPENDENT FEDERAL MEMBER FOR CALARE

Runs on the Board for the Wellington Area

- ✓ \$12 million in disaster funding for the Duke of Wellington Bridge
- ✓ Secured upgrade of Wellington Hospital Emergency Department
- ✓ \$560,000 for Stuart Town water security project
- ✓ \$46,454 for Geurie Racecourse and Recreation Reserve Revitalisation Project Stage Two
- ✓ \$650,000 for upgrades at Wellington Christian School
- ✓ \$46,454 for Geurie Racecourse and Recreation Reserve Revitalisation Project
- ✓ \$2.02 million for replacing the Terrabella, Burrendong and Gundy Creek Bridges
- ✓ \$200,000 for improvements at Kennard Park
- ✓ Video link for Wellington Court House
- ✓ \$738,000 for the Cameron Park footbridge
- ✓ \$1.1 million for Ponto Falls Road upgrade

- ✓ \$26,700 for the Driver Reviver site at the Wellington Information Centre
- ✓ \$1.176 million for improvements at Wellington Caves
- ✓ \$1.5 million for the intergenerational childcare facility at Maranatha House
- ✓ \$1.2 million for security CCTV in Wellington and Calare communities
- ✓ \$50,000 for Wellington Library’s outdoor reading room



✓ \$9.5 million to build a new, purpose built wing focused on dementia and palliative care at Maranatha House

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Authorised by Andrew Gee, MP, Suite 1/179A Anson Street, Orange NSW 2800

6.00 Rage. **7.00** Weekend Breakfast. **9.00** Insiders. **10.00** Offsiders. **10.30** The World This Week. **11.00** Compass. Final. **11.30** Songs Of Praise. **12.00** ABC News At Noon. **12.30** Landline. **1.30** Gardening Australia. **2.15** Portrait Artist Of The Year. **3.10** The Assembly. **4.00** Creative Types With Virginia Trioli. **4.30** Amanda & Alan's Italian Job. **5.00** Take 5 With Zan Rowe. **5.30** Back Roads. **6.00** Antiques Roadshow. **7.00** ABC News. **7.30** Portrait Artist Of The Year. **8.20** Treasure & Dirt. Final. **9.20** Falling. **10.05** Grantchester. **10.50** Father Brown. **11.35** Late Programs.

6.00 NBC Today. **7.00** Weekend Sunrise. **9.30** Test Cricket: Pre-Game Show. **10.00** Cricket. Second Test. Aust v Bangladesh. Morning. **12.00** Test Cricket: The Lunch Break. **12.40** Cricket. Second Test. Aust v Bangladesh. Arvo. **2.40** Test Cricket: Tea Break. **3.00** Cricket. Second Test. Aust v Bangladesh. Late arvo. **5.30** Sydney Weekender. **6.00** Seven News. **7.00** The 1% Club. **8.00** 7NEWS Spotlight. **9.00** Body In The Snow: The Murder Of Joanna Yeates. **11.30** The Suspects: True Australian Thrillers. **12.30** Late Programs.

6.00 Hello SA. **6.30** A Current Affair. **7.00** Weekend Today. **10.00** Wide World Of Sports. **11.00** NRL Sunday Footy Show. **11.45** Rugby League. NRL Women's Premiership. Titans v Broncos. **1.30** Rugby League. NRL Women's Premiership. Roosters v NZ Warriors. **3.30** Rugby League. NRL. Roosters v Tigers. **6.00** 9News Sunday. **7.00** The Block. **8.40** 60 Minutes. **9.40** 9News Late. **10.10** The First 48. **11.20** Murder In The 21st. **12.10** Surfing Australia TV. **12.40** Iconic Australia. **1.30** TV Shop: Home Shopping. **2.00** Late Programs.

6.00 Morning Programs. **7.00** Joseph Prince: New Creation Church. **7.30** Silvia's Italian Masterclass. **8.00** My Market Kitchen. **8.30** Food Trail: South Africa. **9.00** Freshly Picked With Simon Toohey. **9.30** Good Chef Bad Chef. **10.00** Good Food Everyday With Gary Mehigan. **10.30** Frugal Foodie. **11.00** Farm To Fork. **11.30** Deal Or No Deal. **12.00** Millionaire Hot Seat. **12.30** Gogglebox Australia. **1.30** The Traitors Australia. **3.00** The Finish Line. **4.00** Lingo. **5.00** 10 News. **6.30** 10 News+. **7.00** Gogglebox Australia. Return. **8.00** Watson. **9.00** FBI. **12.00** Late Programs.

6.00 Morning Programs. **12.30** PBS Washington Week With The Atlantic. **1.00** Speedweek. **3.00** Going Places With Ernie Dingo. **4.30** Cycling. UCI World Tour. La Vuelta. H'lights. **5.30** The Exiles: Secretly Deported. New. **6.30** SBS World News. **7.30** Days That Shocked The World: September 11. **9.25** Castle Secrets. **10.20** Kennedy. **11.05** Queens That Changed The World. **1.55** David Baddiel: Jews Don't Count. **2.55** A Hollywood Spy Against The Nazis. **4.00** Bamay. **5.00** NHK World English News Morning. **5.15** Euronews. **5.30** PBS News Horizons.

10.00 The Dog Academy. **1.00** Friends. **6.00** The Big Bang Theory. **10.30** The Traitors Australia. **12.00** Ridiculousness. **1.30** Home Shopping.

6.00 Morning Programs. **10.45** Father Brown. **11.30** Nigella At My Table. **12.00** ABC News At Noon. **1.00** Landline. **2.00** Back Roads. **2.30** Julia Zemiro's Home Delivery. **3.00** Fake Or Fortune? **4.00** Murdoch Mysteries. **4.45** Long Lost Family: What Happened Next. **5.30** Antiques Roadshow. **6.30** Hard Quiz. **7.00** ABC News. **7.30** 7.30. **8.00** Australian Story. **8.30** Four Corners. **9.20** Media Watch. **9.35** Planet America. **10.05** Foreign Correspondent. **10.35** ABC Late News. **10.50** The Business. **11.10** Murdoch Mysteries. **11.55** Late Programs.

6.00 Sunrise. **9.30** Test Cricket: Pre-Game Show. **10.00** Cricket. Second Test. Aust v Bangladesh. Morning. **12.00** Test Cricket: The Lunch Break. **12.40** Cricket. Second Test. Aust v Bangladesh. Arvo. **2.40** Test Cricket: Tea Break. **3.00** Cricket. Second Test. Aust v Bangladesh. Late arvo. **5.30** The Chase Australia. **6.00** 7News Local. **6.30** 7News @ 6:30. **7.00** Home And Away. **7.30** The Voice. **8.40** The Rookie. **9.40** The Agenda Setters: Rugby League. **10.40** The Agenda Setters. **11.40** Happy's Place. **12.10** New Amsterdam. **1.10** Late Programs.

6.00 Today. **9.00** Today Extra. **11.30** 9News Morning. **12.00** The Block. **1.30** Find My Country House Australia. **2.00** Pointless. **3.00** Tipping Point. **4.00** 9News Afternoon. **4.30** Tipping Point Australia. **5.30** WIN News. **6.00** 9News. **7.00** A Current Affair. **7.30** The Block. **8.40** 100% Footy. **9.40** 9News Late. **10.10** Outback Opal Hunters. **11.10** Footy Classified. **12.05** Tipping Point. **1.00** Hello SA. **1.30** TV Shop: Home Shopping. **2.30** Global Shop. **3.00** TV Shop: Home Shopping. **4.00** Skippy The Bush Kangaroo. **4.30** A Current Affair. **5.00** Late Programs.

6.00 Morning Programs. **8.00** Lingo. **9.00** The Finish Line. **10.00** Farm To Fork. **10.30** Entertainment Tonight. **11.00** Gogglebox Australia. **12.00** Everyday Gourmet With Justine Schofield. **12.30** Millionaire Hot Seat. **1.00** 10 News: Lunchtime. **2.00** Deal Or No Deal. **2.30** The Finish Line. **3.30** Lingo. **4.30** The Bold And The Beautiful. **5.00** 10 News. **6.30** Deal Or No Deal. **7.00** Millionaire Hot Seat. **7.30** Deal Or No Deal: Celebrity Jackpot. **8.40** Have You Been Paying Attention? **9.40** 10's Late News. **10.40** The Big Bang Theory. **11.35** Late Programs.

6.00 Morning Programs. **2.00** Junior Doctors Down Under. **2.55** Going Places With Ernie Dingo. **3.30** The Cook Up With Adam Liaw. **4.05** Jeopardy! **4.30** Letters And Numbers. **5.00** Cycling. UCI World Tour. La Vuelta. H'lights. **6.00** Mastermind Australia. **6.30** SBS World News. **7.35** Bill Bailey's Vietnam Adventure. **8.30** 24 Hours In Emergency. **9.25** Alone Australia. **10.30** SBS World News Late. **11.00** Gomorrah. **12.45** Fargo. **2.40** Jersey And Guernsey. **4.20** Bamay. **5.00** NHK World English News Morning. **5.30** ANC Philippines The World Tonight.

10.00 Lingo. **12.00** The Traitors Australia. **1.30** Friends. **3.00** Frasier. **4.00** Everyday Gourmet With Justine Schofield. **4.30** Becker. **5.00** The Inspired Unemployed (Impractical) Jokers. **5.30** The Big Bang Theory. **6.00** Friends. **8.00** The Big Bang Theory. **10.00** Becker. **10.30** Frasier. **11.30** Late Programs.

6.00 Morning Programs. **10.30** Kitchen Cabinet. **11.00** Walking Man. **11.30** Take 5 With Zan Rowe. **12.00** ABC News At Noon. **1.00** Grantchester. **2.00** Back Roads. **2.30** Julia Zemiro's Home Delivery. **3.00** Fake Or Fortune? **4.00** Murdoch Mysteries. **4.45** Long Lost Family: What Happened Next. **5.30** Antiques Roadshow. **6.30** Hard Quiz. **7.00** ABC News. **7.30** 7.30. **8.00** Foreign Correspondent. **8.30** Kitchen Cabinet. Final. **9.00** The Assembly. Final. **9.45** Take 5 With Zan Rowe. **10.15** ABC Late News. **10.30** The Business. **10.50** Four Corners. **11.35** Late Programs.

6.00 Morning Programs. **10.00** Cricket. Second Test. Aust v Bangladesh. Morning. (Alt schedule may be shown). **12.00** Test Cricket: The Lunch Break. **12.40** Cricket. Second Test. Aust v Bangladesh. Arvo. **2.40** Test Cricket: Tea Break. **3.00** Cricket. Second Test. Aust v Bangladesh. Late arvo. **4.00** Seven News At 4. **5.00** The Chase Australia. **6.00** 7News Local. **6.30** 7News @ 6:30. **7.00** Home And Away. **7.30** The Voice. **9.05** Ramsay's Kitchen Nightmares USA. **10.05** The Agenda Setters. **11.05** Happy's Place. **11.35** Late Programs.

6.00 Today. **9.00** Today Extra. **11.30** 9News Morning. **12.00** The Block. **1.00** Ski Rescue Down Under. **2.00** Pointless. **3.00** Tipping Point. **4.00** 9News Afternoon. **4.30** Tipping Point Australia. **5.30** WIN News. **6.00** 9News. **7.00** A Current Affair. **7.30** The Block. **8.45** Trigger Point. **9.45** 9News Late. **10.15** The Teacher: Body In The Lake. **11.15** Footy Classified. **12.10** Tipping Point. **1.05** GolfBarons. **1.30** TV Shop: Home Shopping. **2.30** Explore TV. **3.00** TV Shop: Home Shopping. **4.00** Skippy The Bush Kangaroo. **4.30** A Current Affair. **5.00** Late Programs.

6.00 Morning Programs. **8.00** Lingo. **9.00** The Finish Line. **10.00** Farm To Fork. **10.30** Entertainment Tonight. **11.00** Deal Or No Deal: Celebrity Jackpot. **12.00** Everyday Gourmet With Justine Schofield. **12.30** Millionaire Hot Seat. **1.00** 10 News: Lunchtime. **2.00** Deal Or No Deal. **2.30** The Finish Line. **3.30** Lingo. **4.30** The Bold And The Beautiful. **5.00** 10 News. **6.30** Deal Or No Deal. **7.00** Millionaire Hot Seat. **7.30** The Traitors Australia. **9.00** The Cheap Seats. **10.00** 10's Late News. **11.00** The Big Bang Theory. **11.30** Late Programs.

6.00 Morning Programs. **2.00** Junior Doctors Down Under. **2.55** Living Black. **3.30** The Cook Up With Adam Liaw. **4.05** Jeopardy! **4.30** Letters And Numbers. **5.00** Cycling. UCI World Tour. La Vuelta. H'lights. **6.00** Mastermind Australia. **6.30** SBS World News. **7.30** Shaun Micallef's Origin Odyssey. **8.30** Insight. **9.30** Dateline. **10.00** SBS World News Late. **10.30** Stanley Tucci: Searching For Italy. **11.20** Mozart/Mozart. **1.10** Blackwater. **3.20** Jersey And Guernsey. **4.10** Bamay. **5.00** NHK World English News Morning. **5.30** ANC Philippines The World Tonight.

6.00 Morning Programs. **10.00** Millionaire Hot Seat. **10.30** Becker. **11.00** Lingo. **12.00** The Traitors Australia. **1.30** Friends. **3.00** Frasier. **4.00** Everyday Gourmet With Justine Schofield. **4.30** Becker. **5.00** The Big Bang Theory. **6.00** Friends. **8.00** The Big Bang Theory. **10.00** Becker. **10.30** Frasier. **11.30** Late Programs.

6.00 Morning Programs. **11.15** Back Roads. **12.00** ABC News At Noon. **12.30** National Press Club Address. **1.35** Media Watch. **2.00** Back Roads. **2.30** Julia Zemiro's Home Delivery. **3.00** Fake Or Fortune? **4.00** Murdoch Mysteries. **4.45** Long Lost Family: What Happened Next. **5.30** Antiques Roadshow. **6.30** Hard Quiz. **7.00** ABC News. **7.30** 7.30. **8.00** Hard Quiz. **8.30** Spicks And Specks. **9.00** New Zealand Spy. Final. **9.25** QI. Final. **9.55** Planet America. **10.30** ABC Late News. **10.45** The Business. **11.00** Treasure & Dirt. Final. **12.00** Late Programs.

6.00 Morning Programs. **10.00** Cricket. Second Test. Aust v Bangladesh. Late arvo. **5.30** American Pickers. **6.30** Pawn Stars. **7.30** Outback Truckers. **8.30** Outback Wreckers. **9.30** Outback Truckers. **10.30** Heavy Tow Truckers Down Under. **11.30** Late Programs.

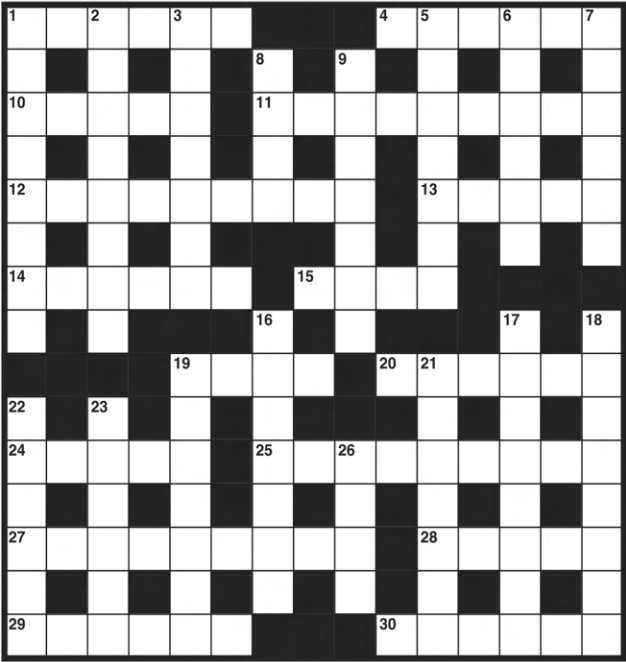
6.00 Today. **9.00** Today Extra. **11.30** 9News Morning. **12.00** The Block. **1.15** Getaway. **1.45** My Way. **2.00** Pointless. **3.00** Tipping Point. **4.00** 9News Afternoon. **4.30** Tipping Point Australia. **5.30** WIN News. **6.00** 9News. **7.00** A Current Affair. **7.30** The Block. **8.45** Banjo And Ro's Grand Island Hotel. **10.00** 9News Late. **10.30** Freddy And The Eighth. **11.25** Accused: Guilty Or Innocent? **12.15** Tipping Point. **1.05** Destination WA. **1.30** TV Shop: Home Shopping. **2.30** Global Shop. **3.00** TV Shop: Home Shopping. **4.00** Skippy The Bush Kangaroo. **4.30** Late Programs.

6.00 Morning Programs. **7.00** Deal Or No Deal. **7.30** Everyday Gourmet With Justine Schofield. **8.00** Lingo. **9.00** The Finish Line. **10.00** Entertainment Tonight. **10.30** The Traitors Australia. **12.00** Everyday Gourmet With Justine Schofield. **12.30** Millionaire Hot Seat. **1.00** 10 News: Lunchtime. **2.00** Deal Or No Deal. **2.30** The Finish Line. **3.30** Lingo. **4.30** The Bold And The Beautiful. **5.00** 10 News. **6.30** Deal Or No Deal. **7.00** Millionaire Hot Seat. **7.30** The Traitors Australia. **9.00** Boston Blue. **10.00** 10's Late News. **11.00** The Cheap Seats. **12.00** Late Programs.

6.00 Morning Programs. **12.30** France 24 International News. **1.00** PBS NewsHour. **2.00** Dateline. **2.30** Insight. **3.30** The Cook Up With Adam Liaw. **4.05** Jeopardy! **4.30** Letters And Numbers. **5.00** Cycling. UCI World Tour. La Vuelta. H'lights. **6.00** Mastermind Australia. **6.30** SBS World News. **7.30** Alone Australia. **8.35** The Airport Chaplain. New. **9.35** James May: Our Man In India. **10.30** SBS World News Late. **11.00** The Congregation. **11.55** Crime. **2.50** Jersey And Guernsey. **4.30** Bamay. **5.00** NHK World English News Morning. **5.30** ANC Philippines The World Tonight.

6.00 Morning Programs. **10.30** Becker. **11.00** Frasier. **12.00** The Big Bang Theory. **1.00** Friends. **3.00** Frasier. **4.00** Everyday Gourmet With Justine Schofield. **4.30** Becker. **5.00** The Big Bang Theory. **6.00** Friends. **8.00** The Big Bang Theory. **9.00** Two And A Half Men. **10.00** Becker. **10.30** Frasier. **11.30** Late Programs.

CROSSWORD



ACROSS

- 1 Nonchalant (6)
4 Black birds (6)
10 Slow motion (inf) (3-2)
11 Storage tank (9)
12 Covered with plants (9)
13 Egyptian capital (5)

- 14 Continues to live (6)
15 Drop (4)
19 Low quality (4)
20 Grab (4,2)
24 Abscond to marry (5)
25 Pleasure seeker (9)

- 27 Objects relating to the US (9)
28 Stage player (5)
29 Northern Ireland (6)
30 The capital of Spain (6)

DOWN

- 1 Buyer (8)
2 European country (8)
3 In the midst of (7)
5 Stone fruit (7)
6 Foreign; exciting (6)
7 Pulpit discourse (6)
8 Group of three (4)
9 Quake-triggered sea wave (7)
16 Row of computer icons (7)
17 Short-distance athlete (8)
18 Made an entrance (8)
19 Childish (7)
21 Buddhist ultimate state (7)
22 Illusion of having experienced something before (4,2)
23 Bumpkins (6)
26 Male pig (4)

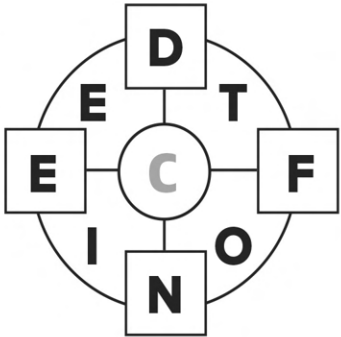


9-LETTER

No. 192

Using the nine letters in the grid, how many words of four letters or more can you list? The centre letter must be included and each letter may only be used once. No colloquial or foreign words. No capitalised nouns, apostrophes or plural words ending in "s".

Today's Aim:
18 words: Good
27 words: Very good
37 words: Excellent

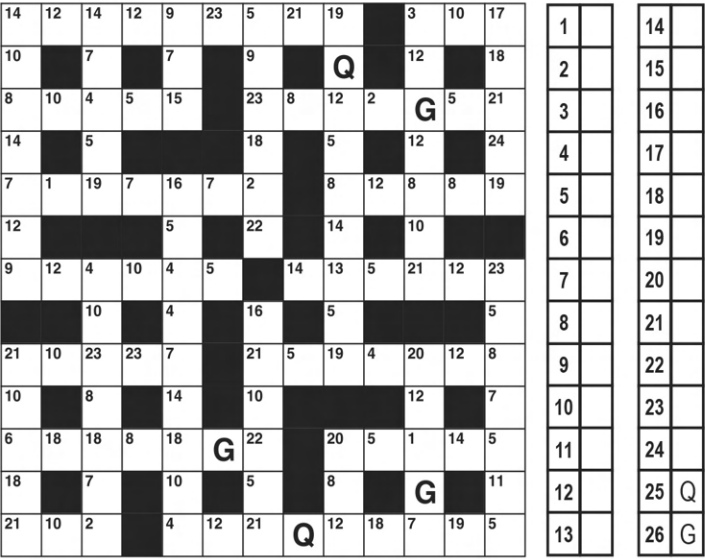


once, tonic
niece, notice, noticed,
inflect, infected, nice,
focul, iced, icon,
focul, fence, fenced,
entice, enticed,
document, edit, encode,
DEFLECTION, dice,
deceit, decent, defect,
cone, coned, confide,
coined, coin, coined,
code, codeine, colli,
cede, cent, cite, cited,

CODEWORD

No. 142

Each number corresponds to a letter of the alphabet. Two have been filled in for you, can you work out the rest?

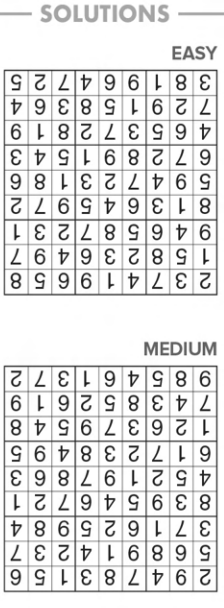
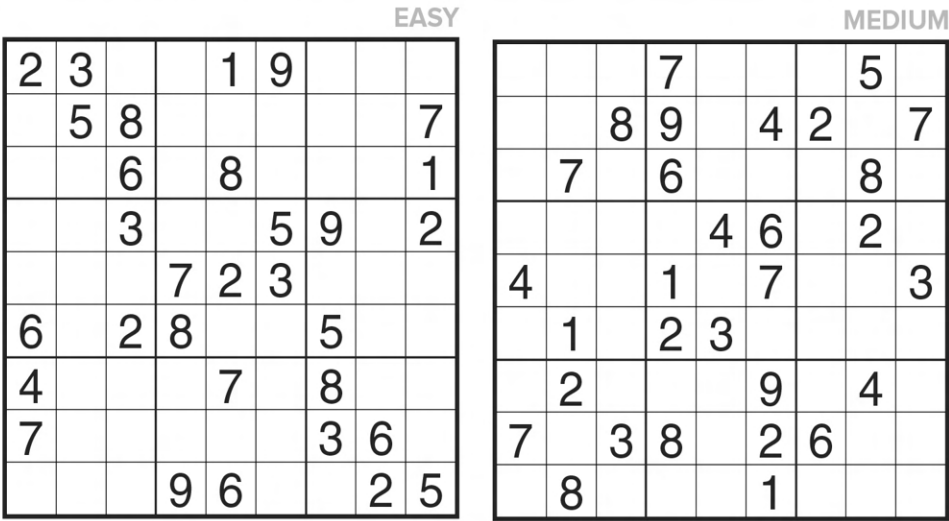


13 = H, 14 = C, 15 = X, 16 = P, 17 = W, 18 = O, 19 = S, 20 = F, 21 = R, 22 = Y, 23 = B, 24 = K

SUDOKU

No. 192

To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every number from 1 to 9 must appear in: each of the nine vertical columns, each of the nine horizontal rows and each of the nine 3 x 3 boxes. Remember, no number can occur more than once in any row, column or box.



QUICK QUIZ

1. What is the name for a slender heel on a shoe that is 5cm or less in height?
2. In the film *Little Miss Sunshine* (2006), what type of car does the family drive?
3. Which US state was award-winning pop star Britney Spears (pictured) born?
4. Who is the president of Austria?
5. Is the humerus found in the arm or the leg?
6. Coulrophobia is a fear of what?
7. In which country did tofu originate?
8. What term is used to describe a drink such as wine or cider that is heated, sweetened and spiced?
9. Are fraternal twins produced from two different eggs, or a single egg that's divided into two embryos?
10. What were lyrebirds named for?



ANSWERS: 1. Kitten heel 2. Volkswagen bus 3. Mississippi 4. Alexander Van der Bellen 5. Arm 6. Clowns 7. China 8. Mulled 9. Two different eggs 10. The lyre, an ancient Greek musical instrument.

WORDFIT

No. 102

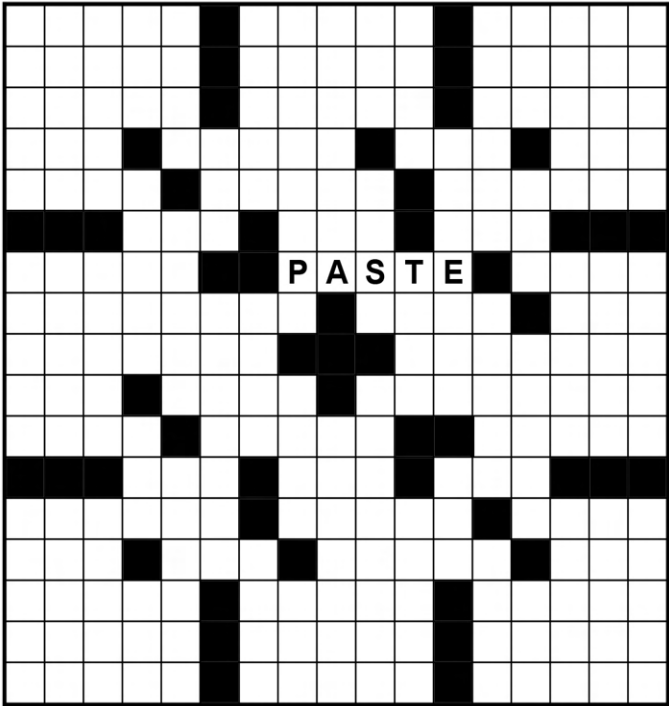
3 LETTERS

- ADD
AXE
BED
BUN
CHI
CUR
ELK
EVE
EWE
GYM
LIE
MEN
OIL
PLY
RED
SHE
SHY
SPA
TAR
TEA
TEE
TEN
TOO
WHO

- PASS
SASH
TACO
TEST

5 LETTERS

- ABIDE
ABLER
ALIEN
ALIVE
ALPHA
ALTAR
ANGLE
ANGRY
ASIDE
BEACH
CARAT
DELTA
EDICT
ELITE
EVOKE
EXILE
FRAME
FRILL
GASES
HANDS
HOUSE
ICONS
ISLES
OVERS
PASSE
PASTA
PASTE
PEEKS
PHONE
PIANO
PLEAS



- REBEL
RESIN
RIDGE
RISEN
RODEO
SCRAP
SEEDS
SEEDY
SIDED
SPARE
SPEED
STAYS
SURGE
TAKER
TENET

- TESTS
THESE
TUNED
VENUE

- 6 LETTERS
CEREAL
HEROES
MAGNET
SPREES

- 7 LETTERS
ABORTED
COOPING
COUPLES
EMPEROR
INERTIA
VERBOSE

- 8 LETTERS
DEVELOPS
RECEIVES
SHOULDER
SORRIEST



PUZZLES AND PAGINATION © pagemasters.

WORD SEARCH

No. 102

Can you find all the words listed? The leftover letters will spell out a secret message.



- AFRO
ASYMMETRIC
BANGS
BOWL
BRAID
BUNCHES
BUNS
COMB OVER
CREW CUT
DEVILLOCK
DREADLOCKS
FADE
FEATHERED
FLATTOP
FROSTED TIPS
LAYERED
MOD CUT
MOP TOP
MULLET
PAGEBOY
PAYOT
PERM
PIXIE
PLAIT
QUIFF
RATTAIL
RAZOR
SHAG
SLICKED BACK
SPIKY
SURFER
TWIST
UPDO
WAVES
WEAVE

SECRET MESSAGE: Your hair is a cut above the rest

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AGRI TOPICS

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Man on the Land

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0428 635 994

THIS PAST week we experienced some extremely cold weather coupled with good rain. This week good rain on Saturday and showers on Friday with high humidity.

ABARES forecasts hefty drops for wheat, barley and canola production. Its initial estimates for Australia’s Winter crops being planted with the overall production figure at 54.5million tonnes being 21% below the 2025/2026 total.

At 23.6M/ha this reflects a 7% drop from last season’s planted area with lower forecast yields further factoring into the tonnage figure. A forecast increase in area planted in Victoria and South Australia is likely to be more than offset by falls in Queensland and NSW, while area in Western Australia is largely unchanged.

Abares said high fertiliser and fuel prices, as a function of the closure to exports via the Strait of Hormuz, will continue to impact grower returns. Farmers’ decisions over the past few months have been shaped heavily by seasonal conditions and gross margins.

District veterinarians have had an increase in calls related to grazing canola crops.

Dual purpose canola crops can be a high value fodder crop filling the winter feed gap due to being highly digestible, with a high energy and protein when this occurs remove stock immediately and call a vet if you observe any of the following signs in your livestock: 1.skin reddening or peeling appears; 2. animals show neurological signs; 3. sudden death occurs; 4. cattle stop eating or appear bloated.

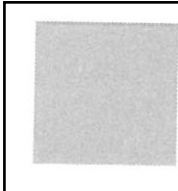
MARKETS AT A GLANCE

Wool Market reopened on AUGUST 17.

CATTLE.. CTLX 11th. 1027 head, down 1195. Substantial rainfall in supply area, quality good and plenty of yearlings for strong feeder market, grown steers and heifers limited. Young cattle sold to stronger trend, heavy grown steers and heifers firm, cows firm to cheaper. Weaner steers to 573c/kg. Feeder steers ave 30c/kg, medium and heavy feeders 490c to 575c, heifers lifted 30 to 35c, 480c to 551c/kg. The few heavy trade 4723c to 520c/kg. Grown steers and bullocks firm, 440c to 495c/kg, heavy grown heifers reached 452c/kg. Best heavy cows firm, 398c to 418c/kg, lighter lower yielding cows back 14c. No restocker activity. 2 score cows 345c to 368c/kg Heavy bulls reached 406c/kg.

SHEEP.. CTLX 12th. 1020 sheep, down 620; 3075 lambs, down 3045. Yarding showed signs of winter conditions. Medium and heavy trade lambs firm to \$4 cheaper, \$253 to \$290. Heavy new season lambs \$288 to \$296, heavy old lambs firm, ave 1060c to 1160c/kg cwt. Heavy lambs \$290 to \$295, extra heavy \$318 to \$347. Mutton prices firm to \$15 dearer; first-cross ewes \$265 to \$300, Merino ewes \$141 to \$222.

**Clearance sale continues phone
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Stock report by Ross Plasto

DUBBO CATTLE.. 3300 head. Good runs young cattle to suit processors, plus top lots of well finished grown steers, heifers and cows, pus young cattle to suit feeders and back-grounders. Young trade cattle firm, vealers and yearlings 448c to 530c/kg. Feeder steers and heifers up to 25c dearer, steers 445c to 570c/kg, heifers 448c to 528c/kg. Following good rain young cattle to restockers were 30c to 50c dearer, steers 425c to 576c/kg, heifers 350c to 490c/kg. Grown steers and heifers up to 15c dearer, steers 440c to 490c/kg, heifers 426c to 484c/kg. Cows 12c dearer, 2 and 3 scores to processors 300c to 399c/kg. Heavy cows 380c to 434c, ave 408c/kg. Cows to restockers dearer 332c to 420c/kg. Heavy bulls to 426c/kg.

DUBBO SHEEP.. 25,280 lambs. Some good heavy weight lambs and trade weights. Good numbers of Merino lambs in most runs, plenty of exotics. Trade lambs \$5 to \$7 cheaper, 20kg to 24kg \$220 to \$305, ave 1215c/kg cwt. Few trade new season lambs \$270 to \$296. Up to 30kg firm to \$3 cheaper, extra heavy \$6 dearer. 24kg to 30kg \$302 to \$343, ave 1165c to 1200c/kg cwt. Over 30kg \$326 to \$380. Trade Merino \$8 cheaper, heavies firm. Trade Merinos \$184 to

\$281, heavy Merinos to \$315. Lambs to restockers \$5 dearer, crossbreds and exotics \$100 to \$270. Merino lambs to restockers and feeders \$160 to \$274. Hoggets to \$285.

MUTTON.. 5500 head. Most grades \$8 to \$15 dearer. Merino ewes \$116 to \$285, crossbred ewes \$173 to \$310. Merino wethers \$112 to \$280, most sheep ave around 870c/kg cwt.

DUBBO STORE CATTLE.. Similar sized yarding, plenty of medium and heavy weaners, light weights limited and showing the effects of cold and wet conditions. Smaller buying group but competition strong and prices were solid.

Light weaner steers under 200kg to \$1240, ave 620c/kg Angus, better breed medium weights 200 to 280kg met very strong demand, \$960 to \$1700, 620c to 640c/kg. Heavies up to 330kg \$1675 to \$1980,ave 600c. Steers over 330kg to \$2375 for around 453kg, most ranged 520c to 560c/kg. Black weaner heifers 500c to 540c/kg, colours 480c to 520c/kg. Light heifers started at \$500 up to \$1140, medium weights \$105 to \$1460, heavy weights to \$2005 for 404kg. The small run of cow/calf units reached to \$2680 for heavy cows with older calves at foot.

Grain producer groups join forces on national advocacy through MoU signing

GrainGrowers has signed Memorandums of Understanding with NSW Farmers and Grain Producers SA (GPSA), strengthening collaboration between the groups on key issues impacting growers.

Under the agreements, the organisations will share information, collaborate, and consult on national policy priorities to deliver a more coordinated advocacy approach.

The MoUs also provide GPSA and NSW Farmers a seat on the National Policy Group (NPG) as observers, providing visibility of Grain-Growers’ policy development frameworks.

The structure also means the organisations retain their own mandate, governance responsibilities and accountability to their members.

This includes the ability to advocate independently on an issue.

GrainGrowers Chair Rhys Turton said the agreements come as growers faced some of the most challenging operating conditions in many years.

“The issues facing Australian grain growers are becoming more complex, from rising costs and regulation through to trade and market uncertainty,” he said.

“By working together, we can amplify and increase our collective influence on the issues that matter most to help deliver better outcomes for growers.

“Each organisation already has an effective advocacy framework in place, but by working together on national issues we can have an even stronger impact.”

GPSA Chair John Gladigau said the agreement would strengthen the collective voice of grain producers

and South Australia’s influence on national advocacy.

“This partnership is about bringing together two respected grower organisations to achieve more for South Australian grain producers,”he said.

“GPSA brings trusted grower representation, policy and advocacy experience and a deep understanding of South Australia’s grains industry, while GrainGrowers brings significant national expertise, relationships and reach.

“By working more closely together, we can build a clearer connection between the priorities of South Australian grain producers and the national policy and advocacy agenda.

“Ultimately, this is about combining our capabilities, speaking with greater weight where our priorities align and delivering better outcomes for grain producers.”

NSW Farmers Vice President Justin Everitt said the agreement would create new opportunities for NSW grain growers to help shape and collaborate on national advocacy priorities.

“We know that agriculture is strongest when grower organisations can work constructively together, and this is a positive and exciting step toward more unified national advocacy,” he said.

“Grain producers right across Australia want strong representation and meaningful outcomes on the issues impacting their business.

“This agreement helps deliver both.

“This partnership ensures the voices of NSW growers are heard and represented in national conversations, and we are looking forward to shared collaboration on the issues that matter to us all.”

*Around the tracks
with Col Hodges*

Racing at Bathurst

A DECISION by local trainer Gayna Williams to test Green Pineapple as a stayer was vindicated when the six-year-old gelding was a runaway winner on Monday at Bathurst.

The only two wins from the previous 26 starts had been over 1100 metres and stepped up in distance to 2000 metres for the Dusty Hooves Media Benchmark 58 Handicap Green Pineapple relished the task with a very impressive performance on the heavy track.

Settling further back than midfield for Dubbo jockey Clayton Gallagher, Green Pineapple (\$3.20 favourite) hit the front entering the home straight and cleared out to win by over four lengths from It Is To Be (Louise Day, \$6.50) and Girly Pop (Olivia Chambers, \$4.80).

Cowra trainer Michael Lynch and Dubbo jockey Ken Dunbar have established a successful association over several years and they combined again to win the 1400m Central West Electrical Maiden Plate with Arwa Miss.

Most punters overlooked recent reasonably good runs at Dubbo and Warren and Arwa Miss started the \$20 outsider in the eight-horse field at Bathurst.

Taking the lead from Bindaree Lass and Step Quick after heads turned for home, Arwa Miss fought on gamely out wide to win by a nose from Samoan Roman (Tom Sherry, \$2.30 fav) on the rails, while Avignon (Mathew Cahill, \$5) was a half-length away in third Place.

Despite being a significant drifter in the betting, Fawltly Affairs won the 1200m NSW Jockeys Association Maiden Handicap for the Rosehill trainer partnership of Richard Freedman and his son Will Freedman.

Fawltly Affairs was the opening favourite at \$2.25 but blew to \$4.20 when the money came for the Michael Mulholland, Dubbo trained Puissance Power which was backed from \$3.30 to \$2.60 favourite.

A last start second to Daisy Duck at Louth after coming from Victoria, Puissance Power (Jacob Stiff) led at Bathurst but was beaten over a length by Fawltly Affairs (Teague Gould) with Forgive Me Father (Coriah Keatings, \$7.50) a handy third.

From the Mack Griffith stable at Mudgee, Hanuman (Molly Bourke, \$3.60 fav) led most of the way to win the 1100m Inland Digital Benchmark 58 Handicap by a half-length from Street Parade (Erin Ellison, \$6) and Torendosetta (Juliet Partridge, \$7).



Racing

TUESDAY

SEPTEMBER

15

Full TAB -7-race card

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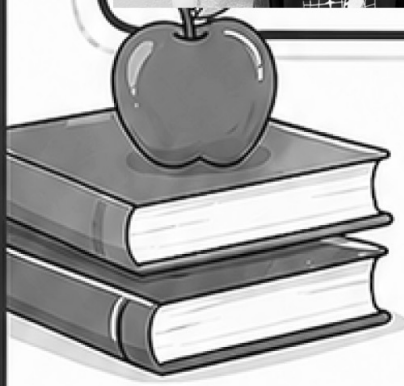
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2026 Wellington Eisteddfod Results

Dance continued from Page 7

11 years Jazz 1 Kenzie Williams; 2 Ivy Joy Halloran; 3 Lahni Holland.
12 years Jazz 1 Ellisyn Smith; 2 Ashley Kang; 3 Eloise Priest.
11 + 12 years Jazz Impro 1 Ellisyn Smith; 2 Kenzie Williams; 3 Emily Lindsay.
12 years + Under Local Wellington Dancer 1 Olivia Beard; 2 Eleanor Reid; 3 Zara Ryan; HC Violet Mitchell; Encouragement award: Polly Whillock; Eva Spradbrow.
9 - 12 years "REACH FOR THE STARS" 1 Ellisyn Smith; 2 Logan Nichols; 3 Kenzie Williams.
12 years + Under Modern Expressive/Lyrical Championships 1 Ellisyn Smith; 2 Eloise Priest; 3 Harlow Verey.
12 years + Under Contemporary Championships 1 Eloise Priest; 2 Ellisyn Smith; 3 Charlotte Steventon.
12 years + Under Classical Ballet Championships 1 Charlotte Steventon.
12 years + Under Hip Hop Championships 1 Ellisyn Smith; 2 Kaliysta Ruttlely.
12 years + Under Tap Championships 1 Sophie Culverson; 2 Ellisyn Smith.
12 years + Under Jazz Championships 1 Ellisyn Smith; 2 Kenzie Williams; 3 Kaliysta

Ruttlely.
Local Wellington Dancer Scholarship – 12 years + Under 1 Olivia Beard.
Encouragement Junior Dancer – 9 + 10 years 1 Harli Putland.
Most Promising Junior Dancer – 9 + 10 years 1 Logan Nichols.
Encouragement Junior Dancer – 11 + 12 years 1 Eloise Priest.
Most Promising Junior Dancer – 11 + 12 years 1 Ellisyn Smith.
Best All Rounder Junior Dance – 12 years + Under 1 Ellisyn Smith.
Overall Best Theatrical Junior Dancer – Tap, Song + Dance, Broadway – 11 + 12 years 1 Sophie Culverson.
Overall Best Commercial Junior Dancer – Jazz, Lyrical, Contemporary – 11 + 12 years 1 Ellisyn Smith.
Overall Best Ballet Junior Dancer – Ballet, Demi-Character, National Character 1 Ashley Kang.
Most Outstanding Performance – Junior – 12 years + Under (Perpetual Trophy) 1 Sophie Culverson.



Intermediate Contemporary Championship competitors.



Reach for the stars competitors.



Senior Championship competitors.



Wellington Public School Kindergarten Dance Group - 1st Place.

More results next week - Don't miss them
The Wellington & District Leader proudly supports the Wellington Eisteddfod
16 THURSDAY, AUGUST 20, 2026, WELLINGTON & DISTRICT LEADER

Redbacks keep grand final dreams alive

WELLINGTON REDBACKS enjoyed a memorable weekend of finals rugby, with three teams keeping their premiership hopes alive and every side showing tremendous determination on the field.

The Under 12s produced one of the most exciting matches of the season against Orange City.

Locked at 17-all at the end of regular time, the game went into extra time, where Wellington dug deep to secure a hard-fought victory.

Tries from Jasper and Connor, combined with the accurate boot of Diesel, who slotted conversions and penalty goals, proved the difference in a thrilling contest.

The win sets up a blockbuster clash with the top-of-the-ladder Mudgee Wombats next Saturday.

A victory will see the young Redbacks book their place in the Grand Final.

The Under 16s left everything on the field in their Major Semi Final against Dubbo Blue.

Despite going down 29-12, the Redbacks never stopped competing and can hold their heads high after a courageous performance.

The loss gives them a second

chance, with a Preliminary Final against Mudgee next weekend to decide who advances to the Grand Final.

Wellington’s Second Grade men also delivered a thrilling performance, defeating Molong 41-39 in one of the closest matches of the New Holand Cup finals series.

Their determination and composure under pressure earned them a place in next weekend’s Grand Final against Narromine Gorillas in Molong.

The Redbacks women’s side also showed plenty of grit and determination but were narrowly defeated by Parkes in Narromine, bringing their finals campaign to an end.

Although disappointed with the result, the team can be proud of the commitment and spirit they displayed throughout the season.

With the Under 12s, Under 16s and Second Grade men all still in the hunt for premiership success, another exciting weekend awaits the Wellington Redbacks as they continue their push towards Grand Final glory.

Carmen Gain



Wellington Warriors Round 13 wrap-up

ROUND 13 had Wellington Warriors continue their push towards the end of the season, with plenty of strong performances, team improvement and exciting opportunities still ahead.

The Over 30s Women went down 4-1 to a strong Newtown side, with Sam Whitney named Players’ Player.

Despite the result, the team continues to show great improvement in their skills and teamwork, with their hard work and commitment evident each week.

The ladies are currently sitting second on the ladder, putting them in a prime position with just two weeks remaining before finals.

Their chances of securing a finals spot are looking very promising, and they will be determined to finish the regular season strongly.

It was a fantastic way for the Over 35s Men to finish their season, securing a hard-fought 1-0 victory over MUFC Sky.

Damo Bell was named Players’ Player following an impressive season.

This year marked a first for Wellington, with the Warriors entering an Over 35s Men’s team into the competition.

The season has seen plenty of familiar faces come out of retirement, new faces to the sport joining the team, and even a few players who may be ready to retire — but clearly aren’t quite ready to hang up the boots yet!

The team has represented Wellington with pride throughout the season, and the club is incredibly proud of what they have achieved. Coming out of retirement for the season,

Damo has been a fantastic asset, bringing years of soccer skills and knowledge to the team.

His contribution has been felt both on and off the

field.

The 1st Grade Women were involved in a thrilling and closely fought match against RSL Navy, eventually going down 3-2.

Georgia Stanley was named Players’ Player after stepping up to take on the role of goalkeeper.

Georgia made several excellent saves and showed great confidence coming off her line to challenge attacking opponents.

Her willingness to put her hand up for the team and perform in an unfamiliar position was a fantastic effort.

The 2nd Grade Men faced a strong MUFC side, going down 5-0, with Nick Streicher taking out Players’ Player honours.

Nick has continued to be a true team player throughout the season, consistently showing commitment, determination and a willingness to support his teammates both on and off the field.

Despite the result, the 2nd Grade Men remain firmly in the finals hunt, currently sitting 3rd on the ladder.

With their finals chances still alive, a win this week against Westside will secure their place in the finals, making the next match a huge one for the team.

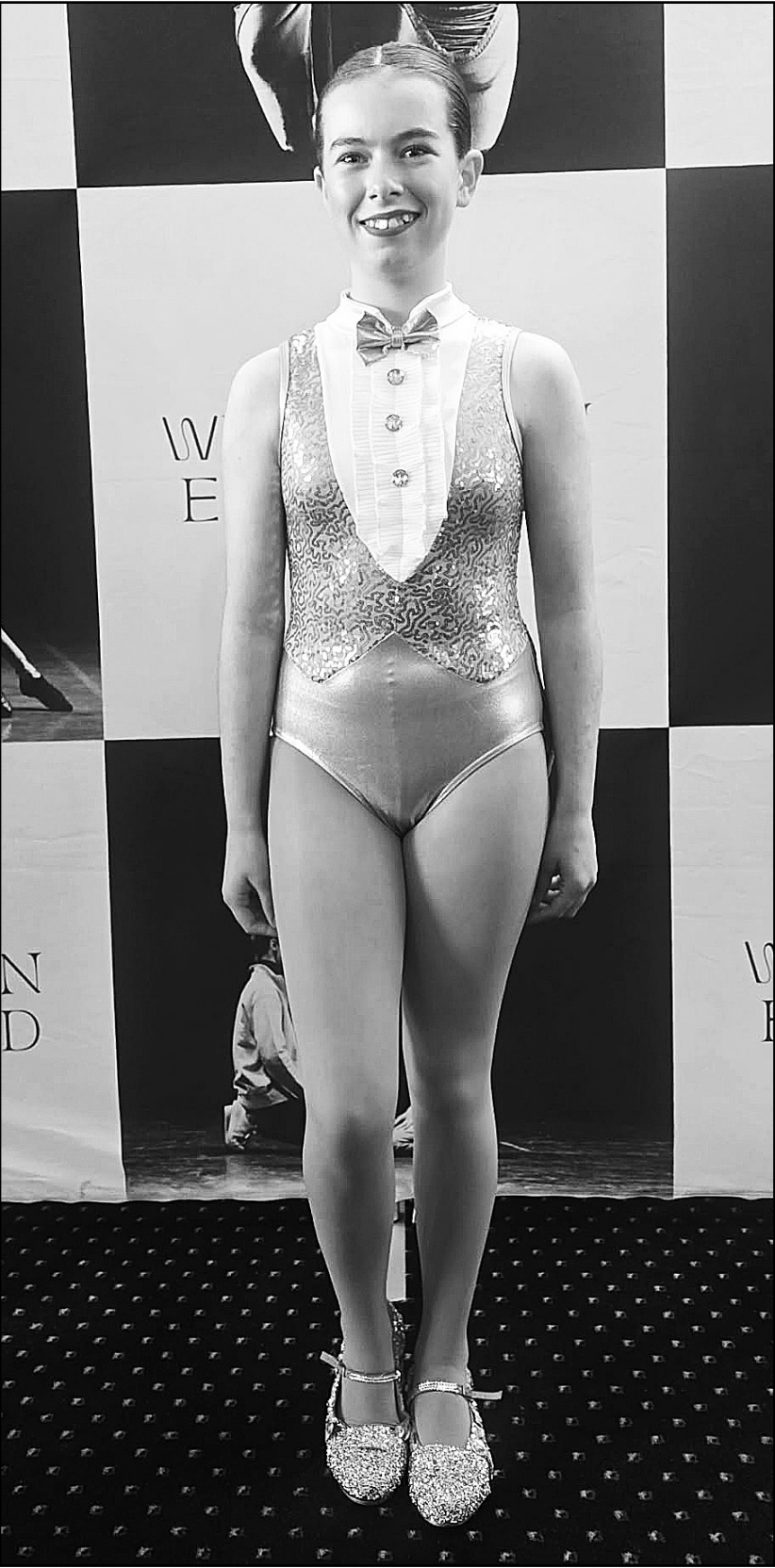
With just two weeks remaining in the regular season, the Warriors are heading into an exciting finish.

We wish all of our Warriors the very best of luck over the next fortnight as they battle it out for a place in the finals.

We hope to see plenty of Warriors teams featuring in the finals — bring on the finish to the season!

Jess Chown

Snapped at the Eisteddfod

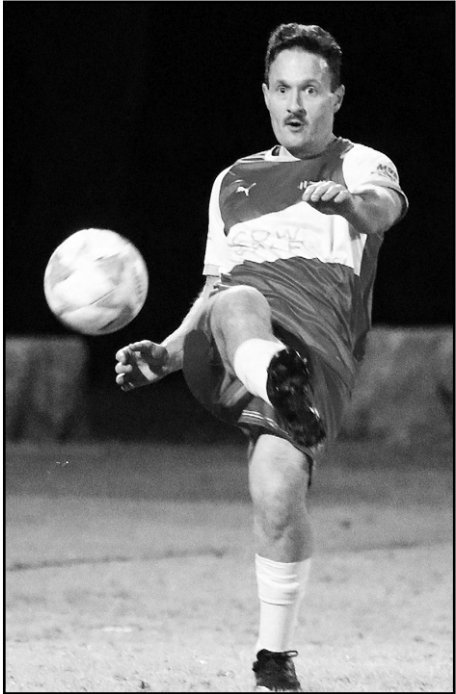
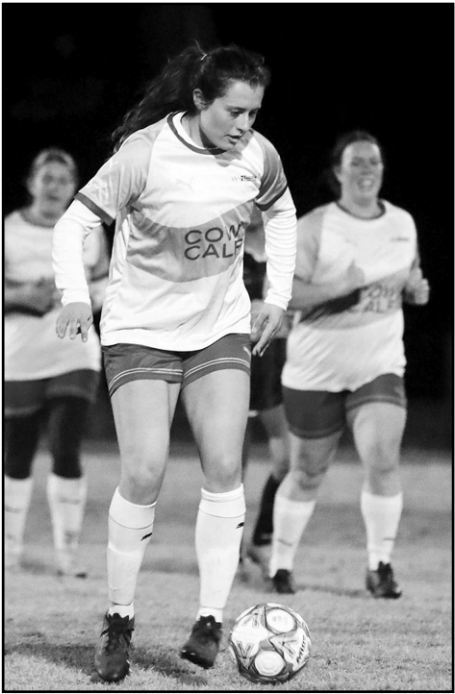


Polly Whillock - 3rd place 11&12 years.



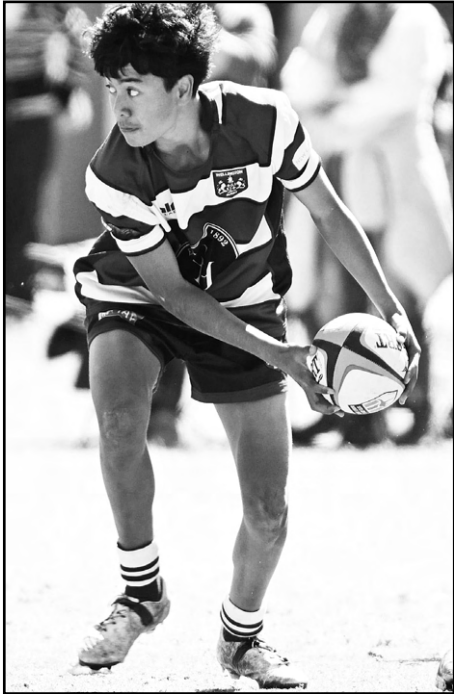
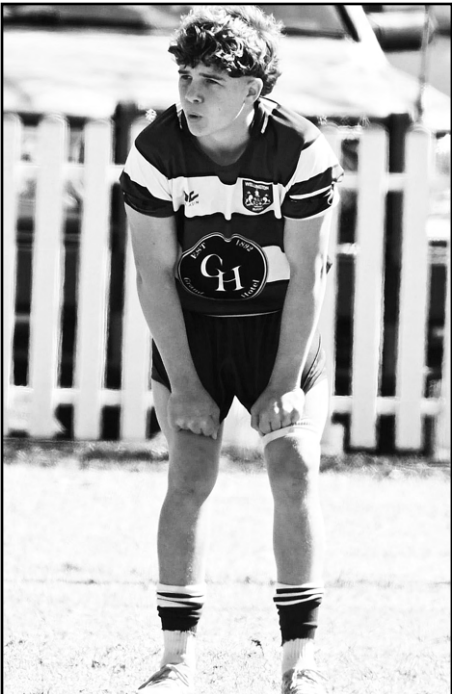
Warriors heading into exciting season finish

Jo Ivey photos



Redbacks last weekend

Under 12s -Win ; Under 16s - Loss - Carmen Gain photos



Golfing News

Weather turned-on for Saturday golfers

COLDER WEATHER early in the week changed to near perfect to greet Saturday golfers.

A special mention to Kurt and Mitchell Cusack, and Nathan Stewart who ventured to Kooindai Waters to play in the Vardon Cup day.

Alas, only Mitchell won a prize - runner up with a 73 off the stick, great effort.

Last Saturday's event was an Individual Stableford with A grade winner Rod McMahon who had to do all the work on his own to finish with 38pts.

Runner-up prize went to Kurt Cusack who finished with 35pts.

B grade winner was Brad Conn who compiled a good score of 36pts while runner-up was Peter Neuenhaus with 35pts.

Prize winners were John Gersbach, Noel Stanford, Paul West, Gary McCarroll, Micheal Britton, Mathew Reid, Cody Conn 33pts; Gareth Petersen, Patrick Slack-Smith 32pts on a countback.

Nearest the Pin on the 3rd Bryan Kiss, 8th Rod McMahon, 14th Brad Conn, 16th Paul West.

NTP in two shots on the 7th was Kurt Cusack.

Longest drives on the first hole went to Kurt Cusack in A grade and in B grade it went to Warren Williams, welcome back Warren.

The Brent Eather Encouragement award was taken out by Harrison Barnes from Dubbo and he only finished with 22pts, might have been the company he kept as they didn't go much better.

Wednesday's Individual Stableford winner with a great effort was Noella Baker who cleaned up the field with

37pts.

Runner-up went to Gae Drew who is in purple patch at the moment, she finished with 32pts on a countback.

Prize winner was Jan Payne 32pts. NTP, Wendy Slack-Smith.

Ladies Pennants Team's next venture is against Dubbo in Bathurst on August 27.

Thursday's Individual Stableford was won by John Gersbach who is claiming wins with his handicap going up, must be a GSOH TRIP coming up, final score 34pts on a c/b.

Runner-up went to the unluckiest golfer Jimmy Armstrong who also finished with 34pts.

Prize winners were, Steven McCarroll, Paul Hannelly, James Fleming 33pts.

Quarter Final of the Lion of Waterloo Trophy to be played by August 22.

There are no PREFERRED LIES on any competition days.

The CORING of the GREENS is set down for Monday and Tuesday, September 7 and 8, and volunteers would be very much appreciated.

This Saturday's events are an Individual Stableford plus the Quarter Finals of the Lion of Waterloo Trophy.

19th Hole



Rod McMahon lifted his game last Saturday to win the A grade Individual Stableford.

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Get your news, results and photos to
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